MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS ENGLISH

LEVEL 2

SPELLING & GRAMMAR • 2-PAGE SPREAD MASTERY

SPELLING & GRAMMAR
MASTERY GUIDE

Spelling, punctuation & complex grammar for a confident Level 2 writing pass

ADVANCED SPELLING | COMPLEX PUNCTUATION | FORENSIC PROOFREADING | FULL ANSWER KEY

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS · COMPLETE SPAG CURRICULUM DIRECTORY

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The Complete 2-Page Spread Grammar, Punctuation & Vocabulary Workbook

PEARSON EDEXCEL

SPaG MASTERY

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Master Functional Skills • SPaG Mastery Manual • Grammar, Punctuation & Spelling

Lead Tutor: Abdul • **Edition:** 2026/2027 Reformed Standards

DIAGNOSTIC AUDIT • QUESTIONS 1–3

Baseline Diagnostic Assessment • Part 1 of 4

Answer each question. Circle your chosen answer. Do not use a dictionary.

1 **Identify the sentence that correctly resolves the comma splice:** **(1 mark)**
(Unit 1: Sentence Boundaries)

- ☐ The audit was completed early, the report was submitted on time.
- ☐ The audit was completed early; the report was submitted on time.
- ☐ The audit was completed early the report was submitted on time.
- ☐ The audit was completed early, however the report was submitted on time.

2 **Which sentence correctly punctuates the fronted adverbial clause?** (Unit 2: Commas for Complex Sentences) **(1 mark)**

- ☐ Although the fire alarm sounded three times none of the staff evacuated.
- ☐ Although the fire alarm sounded three times, none of the staff evacuated.
- ☐ Although, the fire alarm sounded three times none of the staff evacuated.
- ☐ Although the fire alarm sounded three times none of the staff, evacuated.

3 **Select the sentence with correct colon punctuation introducing a list:** (Unit 3: Colons & Semicolons) **(1 mark)**

- ☐ The new safety policy requires: steel-capped boots, high-vis vests, and hard hats.
- ☐ All site operatives must wear the following items: steel-capped boots, high-vis vests, and hard hats.
- ☐ All site operatives must wear: steel-capped boots, high-vis vests, and hard hats.
- ☐ The required items are: steel-capped boots, high-vis vests, and hard hats.

DIAGNOSTIC AUDIT • QUESTIONS 4–6

Baseline Diagnostic Assessment • Part 2 of 4

Identify the correct sentence structure, punctuation, and capitalisation.

4 **Choose the sentence with 100% accurate apostrophe usage:** **(1 mark)**

(Unit 4: Apostrophes)

- [ ] The company updated it's policy regarding the directors' company vehicles.
- [ ] The company updated its policy regarding the director's company vehicles.
- [ ] The company updated its' policy regarding the directors' company vehicles.
- [ ] The company updated its policy regarding the directors' company vehicles.

5 **Which sentence accurately quotes the health inspector's exact words in formal British style?** (Unit 5: Speech Marks & Quotations) **(1 mark)**

- [ ] The inspector stated, "All hygiene records must be updated immediately."
- [ ] The inspector stated "All hygiene records must be updated immediately".
- [ ] The inspector stated, 'All hygiene records must be updated immediately'.
- [ ] The inspector stated, "All hygiene records must be updated immediately".

6 **Identify the grammatically standard subject-verb agreement:** **(1 mark)**

(Unit 6: Subject-Verb Agreement)

- [ ] Neither the clinical team nor the lead surgeon were aware of the missing steriliser.
- [ ] A detailed range of modern healthcare solutions were presented to the trust.
- [ ] Neither the clinical team nor the lead surgeon was aware of the missing steriliser.
- [ ] The committee have decided to dismiss the contractor immediately.

DIAGNOSTIC AUDIT • QUESTIONS 7–8

Baseline Diagnostic Assessment • Part 3 of 4

Grammar and syntax accuracy questions, followed by the diagnostic benchmark rubric.

7 **Which sentence maintains logical, consistent chronological verb tenses?** (Unit 7: Tense Consistency) **(1 mark)**

- [ ] When the customer complained, the supervisor steps in and offered a refund.
- [ ] When the customer complained, the supervisor stepped in and offered a refund.
- [ ] When the customer complains, the supervisor stepped in and offered a refund.
- [ ] When the customer had complained, the supervisor steps in and offers a refund.

8 **Select the sentence with unambiguous pronoun agreement:** (Unit 8: Pronoun Precision) **(1 mark)**

- [ ] The manager told the technician that he had made a configuration error.
- [ ] After consulting with Dr Ellis, Sarah confirmed that the doctor would sign the discharge letter.
- [ ] When the laptop fell from the desk, it shattered into pieces.
- [ ] Between you and I, the promotion criteria should be reviewed.

Diagnostic Performance Matrix & Recommended Study Pathway

Score Range	Readiness Level	Recommended Curriculum Route
8 – 10 Marks	Advanced SPaG Mastery	Focus on high-speed proofreading accuracy and nuanced exam questions (Units 3, 8 & 11).
5 – 7 Marks	Intermediate Competence	Review Units 1, 2, 4, 6 and 9 carefully to eliminate recurring workplace writing errors.
0 – 4 Marks	Foundation Priority	Work through all 11 units systematically in the Murphy 2-page spread sequence.

DIAGNOSTIC AUDIT • QUESTIONS 9–10 & STUDY PLAN

Baseline Diagnostic Assessment • Part 4 of 4

Final vocational diagnostic questions and your personalised revision action plan.

9 **Which sentence achieves the most appropriate formal vocational register for a client report?** (Unit 9: Formal Register & Tone) **(1 mark)**

- [ ] We got super fed up with the delays and had a huge row with the delivery folks.
- [ ] We were bitterly disappointed and are gonna demand a full refund pronto.
- [ ] Following repeated consignment delays, formal representations were made to the carrier.
- [ ] You lot need to fix this massive mess before we get totally outraged.

10 **Select the sentence that uses both homophones correctly:** (Unit 11: Advanced Homophones) **(1 mark)**

- [ ] The new working hours will not effect our daily legal practise.
- [ ] The new working hours will not affect our daily legal practice.
- [ ] The new working hours will not effect our daily legal practice.
- [ ] The new working hours will not affect our daily legal practise.

Tutor Golden Rule

Check your diagnostic score against the answer keys in the Reference Section.

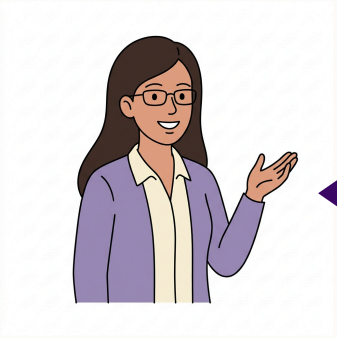
Revision Target

Prioritise the specific units flagged in questions you found challenging.

✎ Candidate Action Plan & Priority Units to Master

UNIT 1 • GRAMMAR & SENTENCE SYNTAX

1 Sentence Boundaries & Eradicating Sentence Fragments



Priya

A The Concept in Practice: Daily Site Supervisor Log & Shift Briefing

B Core Syntax Architecture: The Complete Sentence vs The Fragment

A grammatically complete sentence in standard English requires three non-negotiable elements:

[Subject: Who or What] + **[Finite Verb: Tensed Action or State]** + **[Complete Thought: Independent Clause]** + **[Terminal Punctuation: . / ? / !]**

The Three Primary Causes of Sentence Fragments:

- **1. Stranded Subordinate Clause:** Beginning with a subordinating conjunction (*Because, Although, While, If*) without attaching the main independent clause: *'Because the high-voltage generator failed at 06:00.'* (Fragment).
- **2. Missing Finite Verb:** Using a participle (-ing form or past participle) without an auxiliary verb: *'The contractors installing steel girders on Level 3.'* (Fragment — lacks *'were'* or a main verb).
- **3. Missing Subject:** Launching into an action without identifying the actor: *'Reported the hydraulic fluid leak to senior management.'* (Fragment).

× Common Error

Because the structural engineer identified hairline fractures in the retaining wall on Wednesday morning.

✓ Model Solution

Because the structural engineer identified hairline fractures in the retaining wall on Wednesday morning, all excavation work was immediately halted.

Rule: The dependent clause beginning with 'Because' was attached to an independent main clause with a subject ('all excavation work') and finite verb ('was halted'), resolving the fragment.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 1 Workplace Context (Daily Site Sup...

1 Identify the grammatically complete sentence suitable for an official site log:

- ☐ While the crane operator was completing the routine pre-shift hydraulic checks.
- ☐ The crane operator completed the routine pre-shift hydraulic checks before hoisting commenced.
- ☐ The crane operator completing the routine pre-shift hydraulic checks on Level 4.

2 Which statement contains a stranded subordinate clause fragment?

- ☐ Although safety netting was secured, high winds prompted the site manager to suspend operations.
- ☐ High winds prompted the site manager to suspend operations, although safety netting was secured.
- ☐ Although high winds and severe turbulence were recorded across the coastal development zone.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

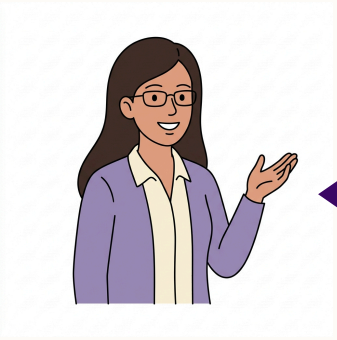
3 **[Rewrite to eradicate the fragment]:** *Although the cement mixer broke down at mid-day.*

4 **[Insert a subject and auxiliary verb]:** *Working overtime on the motorway bypass.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 1

UNIT 2 • PUNCTUATION & SENTENCE MECHANICS

2 The Comma Splice & How to Fix It (4 Statutory Methods)



Abdul

A The Concept in Practice: Hospital Acute Ward Shift Handover Memo

★ B The Comma Splice: Definition & Four Statutory Corrections

A **comma splice** occurs when two independent clauses (complete grammatical sentences capable of standing alone) are linked using only a comma without an appropriate coordinating conjunction.

Clause 1 (Independent) + **, (COMMA ONLY = ERROR!)** + **Clause 2 (Independent)**

The Four Statutory Examiner-Approved Solutions:

- **Method 1: Two Separate Sentences:** Insert a full stop and capitalize: *'The patient responded well to medication. Her vital signs stabilized.'*
- **Method 2: Semicolon Connection:** Use a semicolon to link closely related thoughts: *'The patient responded well to medication; her vital signs stabilized.'*
- **Method 3: Coordinating Conjunction (FANBOYS):** Add a comma and *for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so*: *'The patient responded well to medication, and her vital signs stabilized.'*
- **Method 4: Complex Subordination:** Convert one clause using a subordinating conjunction: *'Because the patient responded well to medication, her vital signs stabilized.'*

× Common Error

Blood glucose readings were taken at 06:00, the patient was administered ten units of fast-acting insulin.

✓ Model Solution

Blood glucose readings were taken at 06:00; subsequently, the patient was administered ten units of fast-acting insulin.

Rule: The two independent clauses were linked using a semicolon and conjunctive adverb ('subsequently'), completely eliminating the comma splice.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 2 Workplace Context (Hospital Acute...

1 Identify the sentence containing an ungrammatical comma splice:

- ☐ Ward 4 reached full capacity at midnight, therefore three patients were transferred.
- ☐ Ward 4 reached full capacity at midnight; three patients were transferred.
- ☐ Ward 4 reached full capacity at midnight, so three patients were transferred.

2 Which sentence demonstrates statutory Method 3 (coordinating conjunction) to fix a comma splice?

- ☐ The pharmacy was closed, we obtained emergency supplies from Ward B.
- ☐ The pharmacy was closed, but we obtained emergency supplies from Ward B.
- ☐ The pharmacy was closed; however, we obtained emergency supplies from Ward B.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Fix using a semicolon]:** *The lab results arrived late, the doctor adjusted the dosage.*

4 **[Fix using FANBOYS (conjunction)]:** *The ECG showed irregular rhythms, the consultant requested an echocardiogram.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 2

UNIT 3 • PUNCTUATION & SENTENCE MECHANICS

3 Commas with Coordinating Conjunctions (FANBOYS)

Marcus

A The Concept in Practice: Warehouse Procurement & Stock Audit Memorandum

B The FANBOYS Rule: Compound Sentences vs Compound Predicates

The acronym **FANBOYS** represents the seven coordinating conjunctions: **For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So**.

[Independent Clause 1] + **, [COMMA]** + **[FANBOYS Conjunction]** + **[Independent Clause 2]**

The Crucial Distinction:

- **Compound Sentence (Comma Required):** Both sides have their own grammatical subject and verb: *'The logistics depot dispatched 400 pallets, **and** the delivery fleet arrived on schedule.'* (Depot + dispatched / fleet + arrived).
- **Compound Predicate (NO Comma):** One subject performs two actions joined by a conjunction: *'The logistics depot dispatched 400 pallets **and** notified the retail regional hub.'* (No comma — 'notified' shares the subject 'depot').

× Common Error

The procurement team audited the damaged stock, and issued a credit note to the supplier.

✓ Model Solution

The procurement team audited the damaged stock and issued a credit note to the supplier.

Rule: Removed the ungrammatical comma because 'issued' is part of a compound verb phrase sharing the single subject 'procurement team'.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 3 Workplace Context (Warehouse Pr...

1 Select the sentence with 100% accurate comma placement with a coordinating conjunction:

- ☐ The warehouse received forty containers, and the customs agent inspected each pallet.
- ☐ The warehouse received forty containers and, the customs agent inspected each pallet.
- ☐ The warehouse received forty containers, and inspected each pallet.

2 Which sentence contains an unnecessary, incorrect comma before 'but'?

- ☐ The shipment arrived on time, but the documentation was missing.
- ☐ The supervisor checked the consignment, but found three broken seals.
- ☐ Forklifts were operational, but drivers were required to wear high-vis jackets.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

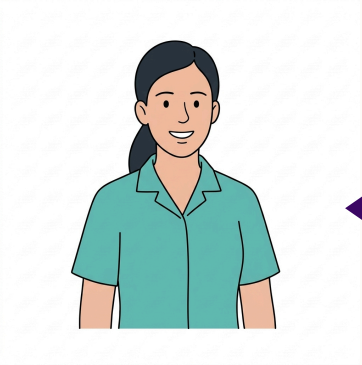
3 **[Insert comma if required (or write 'No comma')]:** *The supplier promised delivery by noon but the freight vehicle was delayed.*

4 **[Insert comma if required (or write 'No comma')]:** *The audit manager verified all invoices and authorized the payment batch.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 3.

UNIT 4 • PUNCTUATION & SENTENCE MECHANICS

4 Commas for Introductory Clauses & Adverbials



Sarah

A The Concept in Practice: Municipal Council Environmental Planning Review

★ B Fronted Adverbials: The Introductory Comma Rule

When an adverbial word, prepositional phrase, or subordinate clause appears at the beginning of a sentence (before the main subject), it must be followed by a comma.

[Introductory Adverbial / Dependent Clause] + **, [COMMA]** + **[Main Subject]** + **[Main Verb]**

Common Categories of Fronted Elements:

- **Time & Frequency:** *'In October 2026, the council approved the pedestrianization scheme.'*
- **Condition & Cause:** *'If environmental permits are denied, developers must revise drainage plans.'*
- **Concession:** *'Although public opposition was vocal, the planning committee voted in favour.'*
- **Transition & Attitude:** *'Consequently, acoustic barriers will be erected along the western perimeter.'*

× Common Error

Without adequate public transport links residents in the new estate will rely exclusively on private motor vehicles.

✓ Model Solution

Without adequate public transport links, residents in the new estate will rely exclusively on private motor vehicles.

Rule: Inserted a comma after the fronted prepositional phrase ('Without adequate public transport links') to separate the introductory condition from the main clause subject ('residents').

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 4 Workplace Context (Municipal Cou...

1 Identify the sentence with correct comma placement after a fronted clause:

- ☐ When the environmental impact survey concluded the planning committee published its recommendations.
- ☐ When the environmental impact survey concluded, the planning committee published its recommendations.
- ☐ When, the environmental impact survey concluded the planning committee published its recommendations.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct punctuation of a transitional fronted adverbial?

- ☐ Furthermore archaeological remains were discovered during ground excavation.
- ☐ Furthermore, archaeological remains were discovered during ground excavation.
- ☐ Furthermore archaeological, remains were discovered during ground excavation.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

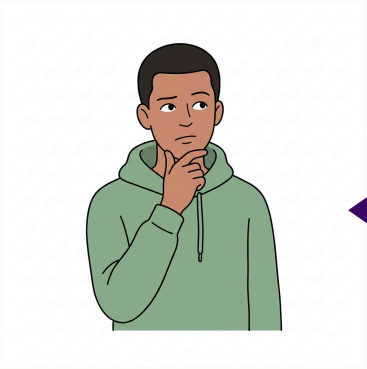
3 **[Add the missing comma]:** *Following the emergency environmental audit the developer ceased all drilling operations.*

4 **[Add the missing comma]:** *To minimize noise disruption for nearby residents acoustic fencing was installed.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 4

UNIT 5 • PUNCTUATION & SENTENCE MECHANICS

5 Commas for Parenthesis & Non-Essential Clauses



Sam

A The Concept in Practice: HR Disciplinary & Grievance Policy Manual

★ B Parenthetical Commas: The 'Lift-Out' Principle

Parenthesis refers to supplementary information, non-essential clauses, or appositives inserted into a sentence. When placed in the middle of a sentence, parenthesis requires **a pair of commas** (one before and one after).

[Subject / Main Clause Part 1] + **, [OPENING COMMA]** +
[Non-Essential Information / Appositive] + **, [CLOSING COMMA]** + **[Main Clause Part 2]**

The Golden 'Lift-Out' Test: If you remove the words between the two commas, the remaining sentence must make complete grammatical sense on its own. *'Mrs Henderson, who has served as HR Director for twelve years, will oversee the investigation.'*
Lifted Out: *'Mrs Henderson will oversee the investigation.'* (100% complete and correct).

× Common Error
The senior investigator Mr Paul Gallagher who was appointed last month has concluded his inquiry.

✓ Model Solution
The senior investigator, Mr Paul Gallagher, who was appointed last month, has concluded his inquiry.

Rule: Enclosed both the appositive name ('Mr Paul Gallagher') and the non-restrictive relative clause ('who was appointed last month') in commas, maintaining syntactic precision.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 5 Workplace Context (HR Disciplinar...

1 Identify the sentence with correct parenthetical comma punctuation:

- ☐ The lead mediator who qualified in 2020 successfully resolved the grievance.
- ☐ The lead mediator, who qualified in 2020 successfully resolved the grievance.
- ☐ The lead mediator, who qualified in 2020, successfully resolved the grievance.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct punctuation of an appositive noun phrase?

- ☐ Ms Clara Bennett, our senior employment legal adviser, will review the settlement agreement.
- ☐ Ms Clara Bennett our senior employment legal adviser will review the settlement agreement.
- ☐ Ms Clara Bennett, our senior employment legal adviser will review the settlement agreement.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

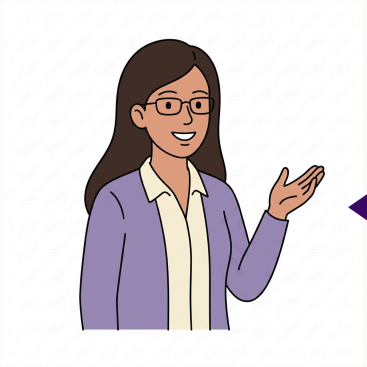
3 **[Insert pair of commas]:** *The head of procurement Mr David Davies will represent management at arbitration.*

4 **[Insert pair of commas]:** *The revised employee code of conduct published in January prohibits workplace harassment.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 5

UNIT 6 • PUNCTUATION & SENTENCE MECHANICS

6 Semicolons — Connecting Closely Linked Independent Clauses



Priya

A The Concept in Practice: CQC Adult Social Care Safeguarding Compliance Report

B The Semicolon (;): Architecture & Conjunctive Adverbs

A semicolon joins two independent clauses that are closely connected in meaning, where a full stop would feel too abrupt and a comma would create a fatal comma splice.

[Independent Clause 1: Complete Sentence] + **; [SEMICOLON]** + **[Independent Clause 2: Complete Sentence]**

Two Essential Level 2 Semicolon Structures:

- **1. Direct Link:** Connecting two clauses without a conjunction: *'The morning medication audit revealed no discrepancies; all controlled drug registers were fully reconciled.'*
- **2. With Conjunctive Adverbs:** Followed by words such as *however, therefore, consequently, furthermore, nevertheless*, followed by a comma: *'Staffing ratios complied with statutory minimums; **however,** weekend agency cover remained excessively high.'*

× Common Error

Care plans were updated weekly, however risk assessments for three residents had expired.

✓ Model Solution

Care plans were updated weekly; however, risk assessments for three residents had expired.

Rule: Replaced the comma with a semicolon before the conjunctive adverb 'however' and kept the following comma, correcting the comma splice.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 6 Workplace Context (CQC Adult Soc...

1 Identify the sentence where the semicolon is used correctly:

- ☐ The care home passed the hygiene audit; because the kitchen was spotless.
- ☐ The care home passed the hygiene audit; the catering manager received commendation.
- ☐ The care home passed the hygiene audit; and the catering manager was pleased.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct punctuation with 'therefore'?

- ☐ Resident room call-bells were rewired, therefore response times improved.
- ☐ Resident room call-bells were rewired; therefore response times improved.
- ☐ Resident room call-bells were rewired; therefore, response times improved.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

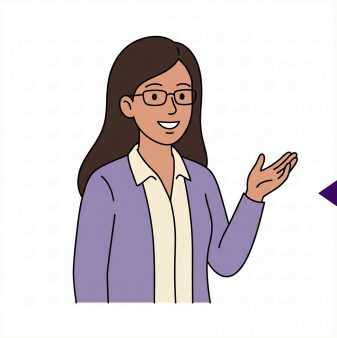
3 **[Replace comma splice with semicolon + conjunctive adverb]:** *The lift was out of service, consequently residents used the ground-floor lounge.*

4 **[Combine two short sentences using a semicolon]:** *Staff morale has improved noticeably. Sickness absence has dropped by 18%.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 6.

UNIT 7 • PUNCTUATION & SENTENCE MECHANICS

7 Colons — Introducing Explanations, Lists & Direct Speech



Abdul

A The Concept in Practice: Industrial Manufacturing Quality SOP

★ B The Colon (:): The Anchor Rule & Introduction Mechanics

A colon introduces an explanation, an elaboration, a list of items, or a formal direct quotation.

[Complete Grammatical Sentence / Independent Clause] + **: [COLON]** + **[List / Explanation / Amplification / Direct Quote]**

The Golden Lead-in Anchor Rule: The clause preceding a colon **MUST be a 100% complete grammatical sentence**.

- **Correct:** *'The maintenance technician carried three essential tools: a torque wrench, a digital multimeter, and a pressure gauge.'* ('The maintenance technician carried three essential tools' is a complete sentence).
- **Incorrect:** *'The essential tools required are: a torque wrench, a multimeter, and a gauge.'* (Never place a colon directly after a linking verb like *are, were, is*).
- **Incorrect:** *'Technicians must inspect components such as: bearings, seals, and gaskets.'* (Never place a colon directly after *such as* or *including*).

× Common Error

Mandatory personal protective equipment includes: safety goggles, ear defenders, and steel-toed boots.

✓ Model Solution

Operatives must equip three items of personal protective equipment: safety goggles, ear defenders, and steel-toed boots.

Rule: The clause before the colon is now a complete independent sentence ending with a clear noun phrase ('three items of personal protective equipment') rather than cutting off a verb ('includes:').

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 7 Workplace Context (Industrial Ma...

1 Identify the sentence with correct colon usage:

- ☐ The machine requires regular lubrication of: bearings, drive shafts, and gears.
- ☐ The machine requires regular lubrication of three components: bearings, drive shafts, and gears.
- ☐ The machine requires: regular lubrication of bearings, drive shafts, and gears.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct use of a colon to introduce an explanation?

- ☐ The production line was stopped for one reason: contamination had been detected in Batch 4.
- ☐ The production line was stopped: because contamination had been detected in Batch 4.
- ☐ The production line was stopped, for one reason: contamination was found.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Rewrite to make the lead-in an independent clause]:** *The emergency shut-off valves are located at: Tank A, Tank B, and the boiler room.*

4 **[Correct the misplaced colon after 'such as']:** *Operators must monitor critical parameters such as: temperature, pressure, and flow rate.*

C. Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 7

UNIT 8 • PUNCTUATION & SENTENCE MECHANICS

8 Dashes & Brackets — Adding Parenthetical Emphasis

Marcus

A The Concept in Practice: Infrastructure Engineering Project Escalation Memo

★ B Dashes vs Brackets: The Emphasis Spectrum

Both dashes and brackets enclose parenthetical information, but they convey completely different rhetorical weight:

Brackets (Parentheses): [De-emphasise Supplementary Data] ↔

Dashes (—): [High-Impact Dramatic Emphasis]

Examiner Rules for Dashes and Brackets:

- **Brackets ( ) for Minor Technical Details:** Use round brackets for acronym definitions, part numbers, dates, or non-essential statistical figures: *'The Building Research Establishment (BRE) published the acoustic report.'*
- **Dashes (— / –) for Strong Emphasis:** Use a pair of dashes to interrupt a sentence with an urgent or contrasting insight: *'The primary support beam — which had shown zero previous signs of fatigue — fractured during load testing.'*
- **Single Dash for Climax / Concluding Twist:** Use a single dash to introduce an abrupt concluding clarification: *'The root cause of the structural failure was not poor weather — it was substandard steel.'*

× Common Error

The emergency bypass valve which was installed only six months ago failed catastrophically under moderate pressure.

✓ Model Solution

The emergency bypass valve — which was installed only six months ago — failed catastrophically under moderate pressure.

Rule: Enclosing the unexpected concession in a pair of dashes provides appropriate dramatic emphasis for an urgent safety escalation report.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 8 Workplace Context (Infrastructure...

1 Identify the sentence with correct bracket punctuation for an acronym:

- ☐ The Health and Safety Executive HSE conducted an unannounced site audit.
- ☐ The Health and Safety Executive (HSE) conducted an unannounced site audit.
- ☐ The Health and Safety Executive — HSE — conducted an unannounced site audit.

2 Which sentence correctly uses a pair of dashes for emphatic parenthesis?

- ☐ The tunnel boring machine — the most expensive asset on site — suffered severe motor damage.
- ☐ The tunnel boring machine — the most expensive asset on site, suffered severe motor damage.
- ☐ The tunnel boring machine (the most expensive asset on site — suffered severe motor damage.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

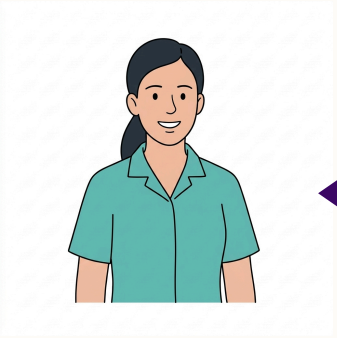
3 **[Enclose supplementary technical data in brackets]:** *The newly installed high-voltage transformer rated at 400 kVA overheated within three hours.*

4 **[Enclose the emphatic contrasting fact in a pair of dashes]:** *The railway signal box unmanned for the first time in thirty years failed to reset automatically.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 8

UNIT 9 • PUNCTUATION & SENTENCE MECHANICS

9 Hyphens — Compound Adjectives & Avoiding Ambiguity



Sarah

A The Concept in Practice: Further Education College Apprenticeship Prospectus

★ B The Compound Adjective Rule & Preventing Ambiguity

A **hyphen (-)** links two or more words to form a single compound adjective when placed **BEFORE a noun**.

[Word 1] + [- HYPHEN] + [Word 2] + [Noun Being Described]

Crucial Hyphenation Guidelines:

- **Before the Noun (Hyphenated):** *'a **state-of-the-art** training academy'*, *'a **part-time** apprentice'*, *'a **well-known** employer'*.
- **After the Noun / Predicate (NO Hyphen):** *'The training academy is **state of the art**.'*, *'The apprentice works **part time**.'*
- **The -LY Adverb Rule (NEVER Hyphenate):** Adverbs ending in *-ly* never take a hyphen: *'a **highly skilled** technician'* (NOT *'highly-skilled'*), *'a **rapidly expanding** sector'*.
- **Preventing Ambiguity:** *'re-sign a contract'* (sign again) vs *'resign'* (quit a job); *'re-cover equipment'* vs *'recover'*.

× Common Error

The engineering firm is recruiting twenty four hour on call field service engineers.

✓ Model Solution

The engineering firm is recruiting twenty 24-hour on-call field service engineers.

Rule: Hyphenated '24-hour' and 'on-call' before the noun 'engineers' to eradicate the ambiguity between 20 workers and 24-hour shifts.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 9 Workplace Context (Further Educa...

1 Identify the sentence with correct hyphenation of compound adjectives:

- ☐ We are seeking a highly-motivated apprentice for a full time role.
- ☐ We are seeking a highly motivated apprentice for a full-time role.
- ☐ We are seeking a highly-motivated apprentice for a full-time role.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct hyphen usage to prevent ambiguity?

- ☐ The technician decided to resign the confidentiality agreement after the audit.
- ☐ The technician decided to re-sign the confidentiality agreement after the audit.
- ☐ The technician decided to re sign the confidentiality agreement after the audit.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

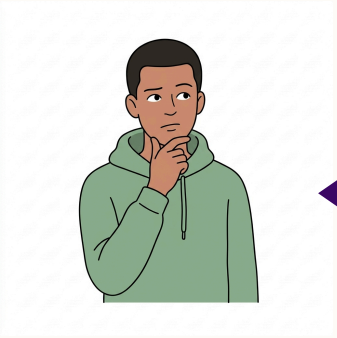
3 **[Insert hyphens where required before the noun]:** *Apprentices will complete a four year degree level apprenticeship scheme.*

4 **[Remove ungrammatical hyphens after an -ly adverb]:** *The company recruits from an exceptionally-talented pool of school leavers.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 9.

UNIT 10 • PUNCTUATION & SPELLING MECHANICS

10 Apostrophes of Omission (Contractions & Professional Register)



Sam

A The Concept in Practice: Corporate Customer Care Escalation Letter

B Apostrophes of Omission: Mechanics & Register Rules

An apostrophe of omission indicates that one or more letters have been deliberately left out when two words are contracted together.

Full Words: [do not] → **' [APOSTROPHE IN PLACE OF OMITTED 'o']** → **Contraction: [don't]**

Key Mechanical & Register Rules:

- **Pinpointing the Missing Letter:** The apostrophe must sit at the exact position of the removed letter: *cannot* → *can't*; *should not* → *shouldn't*; *they will* → *they'll*; *we have* → *we've*. (Placing the apostrophe between the wrong letters, e.g. *does'nt* or *did'nt*, is an immediate spelling failure).
- **The 'Would Have' Trap:** Never write *'would of'* or *'could of'*. The spoken sound originates from the contraction *'would've'* (would have) or *'could've'* (could have).
- **Workplace Register Standard:** In formal business proposals, incident reports, and legal appeals, avoid contractions entirely: use *'we will'* instead of *'we'll'*, and *'did not'* instead of *'didn't'*.

× Common Error

We would of issued a refund immediately, but the client does'nt have proof of purchase.

✓ Model Solution

We would have issued a refund immediately, but the client does not have proof of purchase.

Rule: Corrected the phonetic blunder 'would of' to 'would have' and expanded 'does'nt' to the formal, correctly spelled 'does not'.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 10 Workplace Context (Corporate C...

1 Identify the sentence with 100% correct apostrophes of omission:

- ☐ If you hav'nt received the invoice, we can't process the warranty claim.
- ☐ If you haven't received the invoice, we can't process the warranty claim.
- ☐ If you havent received the invoice, we cant process the warranty claim.

2 Which sentence demonstrates appropriate formal register by avoiding contractions?

- ☐ The executive board will not authorize the settlement until all terms are verified.
- ☐ The executive board won't authorize the settlement until all terms are verified.
- ☐ The executive board will'nt authorize the settlement until all terms are verified.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

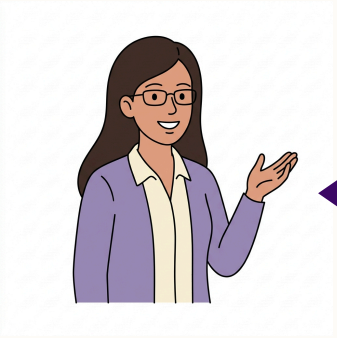
3 **[Correct the misplaced apostrophe]:** *The billing department does'nt open on statutory bank holidays.*

4 **[Transform into formal business register (expand contractions)]:** *We've reviewed your complaint, but we aren't able to offer a full replacement.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 10.

UNIT 11 • PUNCTUATION & SPELLING MECHANICS

11 Apostrophes of Possession (Singular vs Plural vs Irregular Nouns)



Priya

A The Concept in Practice: Commercial Estate Management Lease Agreement

B The Three Rules of Possessive Apostrophes

An apostrophe indicates ownership or belonging. Follow these three non-negotiable rules based on the noun's grammatical form:

Singular Noun: ['s] • **Regular Plural Noun ending in -s: [s']** • **Irregular Plural (no -s): ['s]**

The Three Statutory Possession Formats:

- **1. Singular Owners ('s):** Add *'s* regardless of ending: *'the **tenant's** lease'* (one tenant); *'the **manager's** office'*; *'the **boss's** signature'*.
- **2. Regular Plural Owners (s'):** If the plural already ends in *s*, add only the apostrophe after the *s*: *'the **tenants'** committee'* (multiple tenants); *'the **directors'** board'*; *'the **employees'** cafeteria'*.
- **3. Irregular Plural Owners ('s):** Plurals that do not end in *s* take *'s*: *'the **children's** crèche'*; *'the **women's** network'*; *'the **people's** representative'*.
- **The 'Greengrocer's Apostrophe' Disaster:** NEVER use an apostrophe for simple plurals without ownership: *'We sell apple's and orange's'* is 100% incorrect!

× Common Error

All contractor's must park their vehicle's in the visitors car park.

✓ Model Solution

All contractors must park their vehicles in the visitors' car park.

Rule: Removed the incorrect 'greengrocer's' apostrophes from simple plurals ('contractors', 'vehicles') and correctly placed the possessive apostrophe after the plural noun ('visitors' car park').

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 11 Workplace Context (Commercial ...

1 Identify the sentence with 100% accurate possessive apostrophes:

- ☐ The company reviewed the director's pension scheme and the employees' entitlements.
- ☐ The company reviewed the directors' pension scheme and the employee's' entitlements.
- ☐ The company reviewed the director's pension scheme and the employees entitlements.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct possession for an irregular plural noun?

- ☐ The childrens' play area must be inspected weekly.
- ☐ The children's play area must be inspected weekly.
- ☐ The childrens play area must be inspected weekly.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

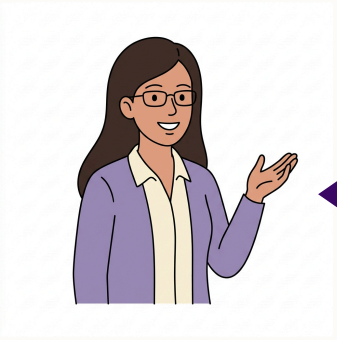
3 **[Make singular possessive]:** *The report written by the auditor was comprehensive.*

4 **[Make plural possessive]:** *The rest room designated for teachers was repainted.*

C. Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 11.

UNIT 12 • PUNCTUATION & SPELLING MECHANICS

12 Its vs It's — The Ultimate Guide & Traps



Abdul

A The Concept in Practice: IT Infrastructure Server Maintenance Protocol

★ B The Decisive Test: Its vs It's

There are only two forms, and each has a strictly distinct, non-negotiable grammatical function:

IT'S = It is OR It has (Contraction ONLY) ↔

ITS = Belonging to it (Possessive Pronoun - NO Apostrophe!)

The Universal Two-Word Replacement Rule: Whenever you write *it's*, stop and replace it aloud with **'it is'** (or **'it has'**).

- If 'it is' fits into the sentence smoothly, write **it's**: *'**It's** (It is) vital that the server is cooled.'*; *'**It's** (It has) been operational for five years.'*
- If 'it is' sounds ridiculous or ungrammatical, you MUST write **its** without an apostrophe: *'The server exceeded **its** (it is?) thermal threshold.'* (Unbelievably wrong! Therefore, write *its*).
- **The Possessive Pronoun Analogy:** Possessive pronouns NEVER contain apostrophes: *his, hers, yours, ours, theirs, **its***. (Writing *its'* is ALWAYS 100% fictional; the word does not exist in English!).

× Common Error

The uninterruptible power supply failed because it's battery had reached the end of it's operational life.

✓ Model Solution

The uninterruptible power supply failed because its battery had reached the end of its operational life.

Rule: Replaced 'it is battery' and 'it is operational life' with the possessive pronoun 'its' without an apostrophe.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 12 Workplace Context (IT Infrastruc...

1 Identify the sentence with 100% correct usage of its and it's:

- ☐ The server cabinet lost it's cooling fan, but its still functioning.
- ☐ The server cabinet lost its cooling fan, but it's still functioning.
- ☐ The server cabinet lost its' cooling fan, but its still functioning.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct possessive usage?

- ☐ Each workstation retains its default network security configuration.
- ☐ Each workstation retains it's default network security configuration.
- ☐ Each workstation retains its' default network security configuration.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Insert 'its' or 'it's']:** *The enterprise software updated _____ database automatically.*

4 **[Insert 'its' or 'it's']:** _____ *imperative that all passwords are reset every ninety days.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 12.

UNIT 13 • GRAMMAR & VERB TENSES

13 Past Simple vs Present Perfect ('I completed' vs 'I have completed')

Marcus

A The Concept in Practice: Civil Engineering Milestone Progress Report

★ B Past Simple vs Present Perfect Architecture

Tense choice depends on whether the time period of the action is completely finished or still connected to the present:

Past Simple: [Finished Action + Finished Time Anchor] ↔

Present Perfect: [have/has + Past Participle + Unfinished Time / Ongoing Result]

The Tense Rules:

- **Past Simple (Specific Finished Past):** Use when an action took place at a definite, finished time (indicated by words like *yesterday, last week, in May 2025, three days ago*): *'The contractor **completed** the ground survey **last Friday**.'*
- **Present Perfect (Present Relevance / Unfinished Period):** Use *have/has + past participle* when the time period is unfinished (*this week, so far, recently, already*) or when the exact date is unspecified: *'The engineering team **has completed** three major milestones **this month**.'*
- **The Common Examiner Trap:** NEVER use the Present Perfect with a specific past time marker: *'We have finished the report yesterday.'* is 100% ungrammatical! Say: *'We finished the report yesterday.'*

× Common Error

Our regional team has submitted the commercial planning application last Tuesday.

✓ Model Solution

Our regional team submitted the commercial planning application last Tuesday.

Rule: Changed 'has submitted' to the Past Simple 'submitted' because 'last Tuesday' specifies a completed, finished time period in the past.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 13 Workplace Context (Civil Enginee...

1 Identify the sentence with correct verb tense:

- ☐ The lead surveyor has inspected the drainage culverts yesterday afternoon.
- ☐ The lead surveyor inspected the drainage culverts yesterday afternoon.
- ☐ The lead surveyor inspects the drainage culverts yesterday afternoon.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct use of the Present Perfect with an unfinished time period?

- ☐ So far this quarter, the company has recruited fourteen apprentices.
- ☐ So far this quarter, the company recruited fourteen apprentices.
- ☐ So far this quarter, the company was recruited fourteen apprentices.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

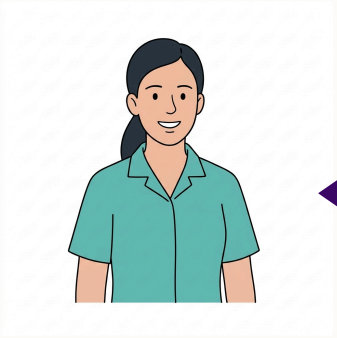
3 **[Correct the tense error]:** *The building contractor has signed the formal lease contract on Monday morning.*

4 **[Complete using the Present Perfect]:** *Over the past six weeks, the safety committee (conduct) _____ five unannounced inspections.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 13.

UNIT 14 • GRAMMAR & VERB TENSES

14 Past Continuous in Incident & Accident Reporting ('was walking')



Sarah

A The Concept in Practice: Logistics Depot Statutory Incident Investigation Log

B Past Continuous vs Past Simple in Incident Narratives

The Past Continuous describes an action in progress in the past, often forming the backdrop against which a sudden incident occurs:

[Ongoing Action: was / were + Verb-ing] + **[while / when]** + **[Sudden Interrupting Event: Past Simple]**

Key Syntactic Conventions:

- **Background Action (Past Continuous):** *'Operative John Smith **was operating** the counterbalanced forklift truck…'*
- **Interrupting Incident (Past Simple):** *'…when a hydraulic hose suddenly **ruptured**.'*
- **Simultaneous Ongoing Events:** Use *while* with two Past Continuous verbs: *'While the engineer **was isolating** the electrical main, the safety officer **was clearing** the workshop floor.'*
- **Examiner Warning:** Avoid shifting into the present tense during incident recounts (e.g. *'The worker was walking along Bay 4 and then he slips'* — keep *slipped*!).

× Common Error

At 11:20, the apprentice was walking through the loading bay and suddenly he drops his tool kit.

✓ Model Solution

At 11:20, while the apprentice was walking through the loading bay, he suddenly dropped his tool kit.

Rule: Eliminated the erratic present-tense slip ('drops') by keeping the interrupting action in the Past Simple ('dropped') subordinated to the Past Continuous background.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 14 Workplace Context (Logistics De...

1 Identify the sentence that correctly combines Past Continuous with Past Simple:

- ☐ While the technician was calibrating the pressure valve, the alarm sounded.
- ☐ While the technician calibrated the pressure valve, the alarm was sounding.
- ☐ While the technician was calibrating the pressure valve, the alarm was sounding.

2 Which sentence avoids an ungrammatical shift into the present tense?

- ☐ The driver was reversing into the bay when the rear sensor fails.
- ☐ The driver was reversing into the bay when the rear sensor failed.
- ☐ The driver reversed into the bay when the rear sensor was failing.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

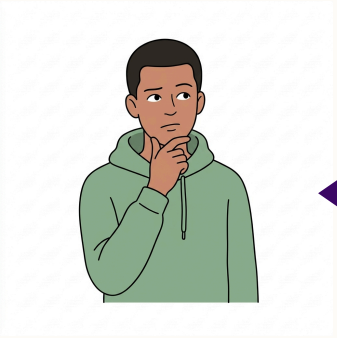
3 **[Combine using 'while' and the Past Continuous]:** *The electrician checked the breaker. Sparks flew from the terminal.*

4 **[Correct the erratic tense shift]:** *The operative was wearing safety goggles when the grinding disc shatters.*

C. Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 14.

UNIT 15 • GRAMMAR & MODALITY

15 Modal Verbs for Workplace Diplomacy (Obligation vs Possibility)



Sam

A The Concept in Practice: HR Disciplinary Grievance & Performance Protocol

B Modal Verb Hierarchy: Obligation, Possibility & Diplomacy

Modal auxiliary verbs alter the certainty, obligation, permission, or diplomacy of a main verb.

[Subject] + **[Modal: must / should / could / would / might / may]** + **[Base Verb: bare infinitive without 'to']**

The Modality Hierarchy:

- **Statutory / Absolute Obligation (Must / Shall):** Non-negotiable legal or safety requirements: *'All personnel **must wear** personal protective equipment.'*
- **Professional Recommendation (Should / Ought to):** Best practice and expected standards: *'Managers **should review** staff appraisals every six months.'*
- **Diplomatic Workplace Requests (Could / Would):** Polite, constructive professional tone: ***'Could you please provide** the updated quarterly figures by Friday?'* (Avoid aggressive imperatives like *'Give me the figures'*).
- **Tentative Possibility (Might / May):** Expressing potential outcomes diplomatically: *'Introducing flexible shift patterns **might reduce** absenteeism.'*

× Common Error

You must send me the client files right now because we need them.

✓ Model Solution

Could you please forward the client files by 14:00 today so that the audit team can finalize the review?

Rule: Replaced the harsh imperative and confrontational modal 'must' with the diplomatic modal 'Could you please', establishing professional courtesy.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 15 Workplace Context (HR Disciplin...

1 Identify the sentence expressing a statutory, mandatory obligation:

- ☐ Staff might consider attending the annual fire safety briefing.
- ☐ Staff should attend the annual fire safety briefing if possible.
- ☐ All employees must complete the statutory fire safety certification annually.

2 Which sentence demonstrates the most diplomatic tone for a performance review?

- ☐ You must completely rewrite this substandard report immediately.
- ☐ Would you be able to revise Section 3 to include more statistical evidence?
- ☐ You ought to fix this awful report before the client sees it.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

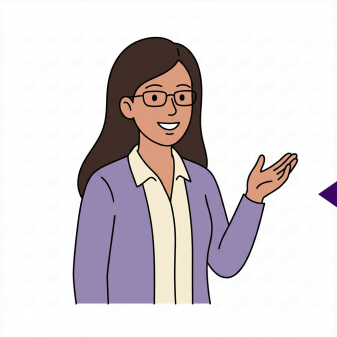
3 **[Transform aggressive command into diplomatic request]:** *Send me the project timeline today.*

4 **[Correct the modal syntax error]:** *The maintenance supervisor should to inspect the boiler weekly.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 15.

UNIT 16 • GRAMMAR & SENTENCE SYNTAX

16 Active vs Passive Voice in Official Reports & Letters



Priya

A The Concept in Practice: Quality Assurance & Compliance Audit Report

★ B Active vs Passive Voice: Syntax & Strategic Deployment

Voice describes whether the grammatical subject of the sentence performs the action (Active) or receives the action (Passive):

Active: [Subject: Actor] + [Verb] + [Object: Receiver] ↔

Passive: [Receiver] + [be + Past Participle] + [(by Actor)]

Strategic Workplace Uses:

- **Use Active Voice for Direct Accountability & Instructions:** Clearly names who is responsible: *'The quality auditor inspected twenty production batches.'*
- **Use Passive Voice for Diplomatic Neutrality:** Avoids personal finger-pointing or blaming an individual worker: *'An administrative error **was made** on the delivery manifest.'* (Instead of: *'Jack made a stupid error.'*).
- **Use Passive Voice for Formal Processes:** Focuses on the object or result rather than the actor: *'The contaminated water samples **were analysed** in an accredited laboratory.'*
- **Forming the Passive Correctly:** Formed with the auxiliary verb *to be* + **past participle** (e.g. *is tested, was repaired, have been approved, will be monitored*).

× Common Error

John dropped the delicate optical sensor, so now the sensor is broke.

✓ Model Solution

The optical sensor was dropped during shift handover; consequently, the equipment was immediately recalibrated.

Rule: Transformed the personal blame into an objective, passive report ('was dropped') and corrected the irregular past participle ('was broken' / 'was recalibrated').

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 16 Workplace Context (Quality Assur...

1 Identify the sentence written in the passive voice:

- ☐ The environmental agency fined the chemical processing plant.
- ☐ The chemical processing plant was fined by the environmental agency.
- ☐ The chemical processing plant paid the environmental fine promptly.

2 Which sentence demonstrates the most diplomatic, professional passive phrasing for an error?

- ☐ You forgot to attach the purchase order number to your invoice.
- ☐ The purchase order number was omitted from the submitted invoice.
- ☐ Your accounts clerk completely messed up the purchase order.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

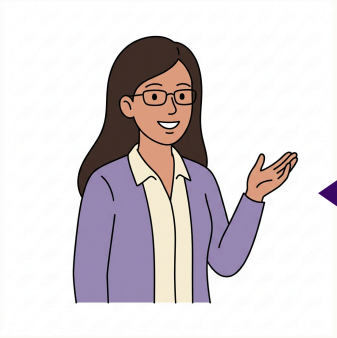
3 **[Transform into diplomatic passive voice]:** *You sent the wrong consignment to the Leeds distribution depot.*

4 **[Transform into direct active voice]:** *Three hazardous chemical drums were disposed of improperly by the subcontractor.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 16.

UNIT 17 • GRAMMAR & SUBJECT-VERB SYNTAX

17 Subject–Verb Agreement with Indefinite Pronouns (Everyone, Each)



Abdul

A The Concept in Practice: Corporate Employee Handbook & Code of Conduct

B Indefinite Pronouns: The Singular Rule

Indefinite pronouns refer to non-specific people or things. In standard English, the following indefinite pronouns are grammatically **SINGULAR** and must take a singular verb:

[Everyone / Everybody / Each / Anyone / Somebody / Nobody / Neither] +

[SINGULAR VERB: is / has / was / does / verb-s]

The Golden Singular Rule: Even though *everyone* and *everybody* refer to multiple people conceptually, grammatically they refer to individuals one by one.

- **Correct:** *'**Everyone** in the regional offices **is** required to complete the safety briefing.'*
- **Incorrect:** *'Everyone in the regional offices are required...'*
- **The Prepositional Phrase Trap:** Words between the subject and the verb do NOT change agreement: *'**Each** [of the fourteen candidates] **has** passed the assessment.'* (Subject is *Each*, NOT *candidates*).

× Common Error

Each of the warehouse operatives have been issued with a safety helmet.

✓ Model Solution

Each of the warehouse operatives has been issued with a safety helmet.

Rule: The subject is the singular pronoun 'Each', which requires the singular auxiliary verb 'has', regardless of the plural noun 'operatives' inside the prepositional phrase.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 17 Workplace Context (Corporate E...

1 Identify the sentence with correct subject-verb agreement:

- ☐ Everyone on the committee have signed the confidentiality agreement.
- ☐ Everyone on the committee has signed the confidentiality agreement.
- ☐ Everyone on the committee are signing the confidentiality agreement.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct agreement with 'Each'?

- ☐ Each of the commercial vans were serviced last week.
- ☐ Each of the commercial vans was serviced last week.
- ☐ Each of the commercial vans have been serviced last week.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

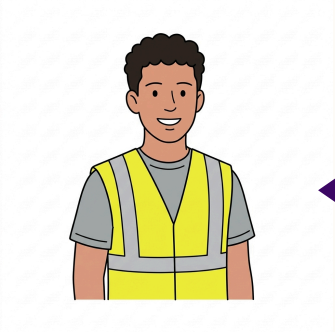
3 **[Correct the verb mismatch]:** *Everyone in the call centre were trained on GDPR compliance.*

4 **[Correct the prepositional trap]:** *Each of the fire alarm sounders are tested every Wednesday.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 17.

UNIT 18 • GRAMMAR & SUBJECT-VERB SYNTAX

18 Subject-Verb Agreement with Neither/Either & Collective Nouns



Marcus

A The Concept in Practice: Trade Union Executive Joint Consultative Memo

★ B Correlative Conjunctions & Collective Nouns

Two advanced agreement challenges frequently tested in Functional Skills English Level 2:

Rule of Proximity: Neither [A] nor [B] + [Verb agrees with B (closest subject)]

1. The Rule of Proximity (Either... or / Neither... nor): The verb MUST agree with the subject closest to it:

- *'Neither the branch manager nor the **supervisors were** willing to compromise.'* (Closest subject *supervisors* is plural → *were*).
- *'Neither the supervisors nor the **branch manager was** willing to compromise.'* (Closest subject *branch manager* is singular → *was*).

2. Collective Nouns (Committee, Board, Management, Staff): In UK professional English, when a collective body acts as a single unified entity, treat it as **SINGULAR**:

- *'The executive committee **has reached** a unanimous consensus.'*
- *'Senior management **is implementing** the recommendations immediately.'*

× Common Error

Neither the safety representative nor the department directors was satisfied with the outcome.

✓ Model Solution

Neither the safety representative nor the department directors were satisfied with the outcome.

Rule: Applied the rule of proximity: the verb must agree with 'department directors' (plural), which is the subject nearest to the verb, requiring 'were satisfied'.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 18 Workplace Context (Trade Union ...

1 Apply the rule of proximity: *'Neither the union secretary nor the shop stewards [___] signed the proposal.'*

☐ has ☐ have ☐ is

2 Apply the rule of proximity: *'Either the shop stewards or the union secretary [___] required to speak.'*

☐ is ☐ are ☐ were

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

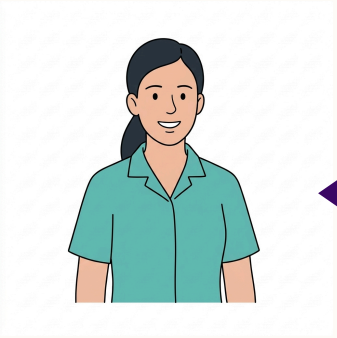
3 **[Adjust verb to match closest subject]:** *Neither the apprentice nor the technicians was able to locate the fault.*

4 **[Adjust verb to match closest subject]:** *Either the team leaders or the shift supervisor are responsible for locking up.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 18.

UNIT 19 • GRAMMAR & SENTENCE SYNTAX

19 Complex Sentences & Subordinating Conjunctions (Although, Whereas)



Sarah

A The Concept in Practice: Capital Investment Business Case Proposal

★ B Complex Sentences: Subordination & Comma Logic

A complex sentence combines one **independent clause** with one or more **dependent (subordinate) clauses** introduced by subordinating conjunctions.

[Subordinating Conjunction: Although / Whereas / While / Since / Because] + **[Dependent Clause]** + **, [COMMA]** + **[Independent Main Clause]**

The Comma Reversal Rule:

- **Fronted Dependent Clause (COMMA REQUIRED):** When the subordinate clause comes first, use a comma before the main clause: *'**Although** upfront capital costs are substantial, operational savings will offset the expenditure within two years.'*
- **Trailing Dependent Clause (NO COMMA GENERALLY):** When the main clause comes first, do not use a comma before cause/condition words: *'Operational savings will offset the expenditure within two years **because** automated sorting reduces labour overheads.'*
- **Contrast Conjunctions (Whereas / While):** Always use a comma when showing direct contrast: *'Option A requires minimal capital outlay, **whereas** Option B delivers superior long-term reliability.'*

× Common Error

Because automated machinery requires high initial investment therefore management hesitated.

✓ Model Solution

Because automated machinery requires high initial investment, management hesitated.

Rule: Removed the redundant coordinator 'therefore'; a subordinate clause beginning with 'Because' leads directly into the main clause separated only by a comma.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 19 Workplace Context (Capital Inve...

1 Identify the sentence demonstrating correct subordination and comma placement:

- ☐ Although revenue grew by 14%, profit margins contracted due to rising freight charges.
- ☐ Although revenue grew by 14% but profit margins contracted due to rising freight charges.
- ☐ Although revenue grew by 14% profit margins contracted, due to rising freight charges.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct punctuation with 'whereas'?

- ☐ Option 1 offers lower annual leasing fees whereas Option 2 includes comprehensive servicing.
- ☐ Option 1 offers lower annual leasing fees, whereas Option 2 includes comprehensive servicing.
- ☐ Option 1 offers lower annual leasing fees; whereas Option 2 includes comprehensive servicing.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

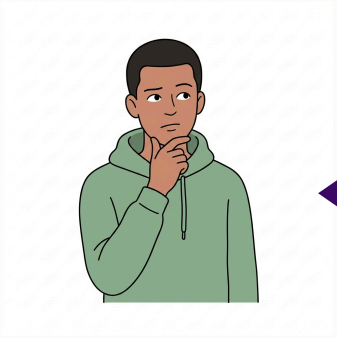
3 **[Remove double-conjunction error]:** *Although the procurement team negotiated a discount, yet the budget remained overspent.*

4 **[Combine using 'whereas' to contrast two options]:** *System A processes 500 orders per hour. System B processes over 1,200.*

C. Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 19

UNIT 20 • GRAMMAR & SENTENCE SYNTAX

20 Relative Clauses & Restrictive vs Non-Restrictive (Who, Which, That)



Sam

A The Concept in Practice: Information Governance & GDPR Compliance Briefing

★ B Relative Clauses: Defining (That) vs Non-Defining (Which)

Relative pronouns (*who, which, that, whose, whom*) introduce relative clauses describing a preceding noun:

Defining / Restrictive: [Essential Info • NO COMMAS • 'that' / 'who'] ↔

Non-Defining: [Extra Info • COMMAS REQUIRED • 'which' / 'who']

The Legal Difference in Meaning:

- **Defining / Restrictive (NO Commas):** The clause identifies EXACTLY which items: *'Customer databases **that contain biometric data** must be encrypted.'* (Meaning: ONLY the databases containing biometric data must be encrypted; others may not need to be).
- **Non-Defining / Non-Restrictive (COMMAS REQUIRED):** The clause merely provides supplementary, non-essential details: *'The primary customer database, **which contains biometric data,** must be encrypted.'* (Meaning: There is only one primary database, and by the way, it contains biometric data).
- **Pronoun Precision:** Use **who** for human beings (*'The data protection officer **who** audited our records'*); use **which** or **that** for inanimate entities, systems, and hardware.

× Common Error

The data protection officer which conducted the GDPR audit approved the records retention schedule.

✓ Model Solution

The data protection officer who conducted the GDPR audit approved the records retention schedule.

Rule: Replaced 'which' with 'who' because the referent is an individual human professional ('the data protection officer').

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 20 Workplace Context (Information ...

1 Identify the sentence using the correct relative pronoun for a person:

- ☐ The systems administrator which discovered the breach notified the board.
- ☐ The systems administrator who discovered the breach notified the board.
- ☐ The systems administrator that which discovered the breach notified the board.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct punctuation for a non-defining (extra info) clause?

- ☐ Server B, which hosts payroll data, was isolated during the cyber incident.
- ☐ Server B which hosts payroll data was isolated during the cyber incident.
- ☐ Server B that hosts payroll data, was isolated during the cyber incident.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

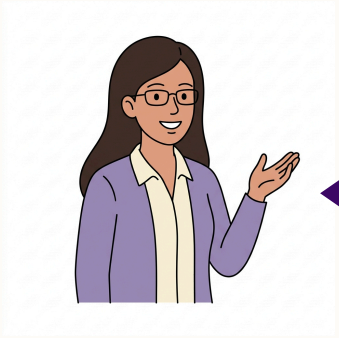
3 **[Correct relative pronoun for a person]:** *The external data auditor which inspected our firewalls praised our cyber security.*

4 **[Insert parenthetical commas around non-defining clause]:** *The General Data Protection Regulation which came into force in 2018 imposes heavy fines.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 20.

UNIT 21 • STRUCTURAL CONSISTENCY & DOCUMENT DESIGN

21 Parallel Structure in Bulleted Lists & Workplace Instructions



Priya

A The Concept in Practice: Clinical Waste Management Standard Operating Procedure

B Parallel Structure: Grammatical Harmony in Lists

Parallelism means using the same grammatical pattern for every item in a list or series.

[Lead-in Sentence ending in Colon :] → **[Bullet 1: Imperative Base Verb...]** → **[Bullet 2: Imperative Base Verb...]** → **[Bullet 3: Imperative Base Verb...]**

Rules for Professional Bulleted Lists:

- **1. Syntactic Harmony:** If Bullet 1 begins with an imperative verb (*'Sanitize'*), ALL subsequent bullets must begin with an imperative verb (*'Seal'*, *'Transport'*, *'Log'*). Never switch to an -ing participle (*'Sealing'*) or a noun (*'Transportation'*).
- **2. Complete Grammatical Lead-in:** The stem before the colon must be a complete sentence: *'Operatives must adhere to the following waste protocol:'* (NOT: *'The protocol is:'*).
- **3. Capitalization & Terminal Punctuation:** In formal Functional Skills reporting, capitalize the first letter of each bullet and conclude each bullet with a full stop.

× Common Error

When handling hazardous bio-waste, operatives must:

- Wearing protective gloves.
- Seal all yellow bags with cable ties.
- Safe disposal in the incinerator bay.

✓ Model Solution

When handling hazardous bio-waste, operatives must execute the following procedures:

- Wear protective nitrile gloves throughout the transfer.
- Seal all yellow bags securely with heavy-duty cable ties.
- Dispose of sealed containers inside the designated incineration bay.

Rule: Restored parallel structure by beginning every bullet point with an imperative base verb ('Wear', 'Seal', 'Dispose') and provided a complete grammatical lead-in sentence.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 21 Workplace Context (Clinical Wast...

1 Identify the bulleted list that demonstrates 100% parallel structure:

- ☐ • Inspect fire extinguishers. • Checking emergency exits. • Replace damaged signage.
- ☐ • Inspect fire extinguishers. • Check emergency exit routes. • Replace damaged safety signs.
- ☐ • Inspect fire extinguishers. • Emergency exit checks. • To replace damaged signage.

2 Which lead-in sentence satisfies the statutory colon anchor rule?

- ☐ The daily maintenance routine consists of:
- ☐ Daily maintenance procedures include:
- ☐ Maintenance operatives must complete three daily tasks:

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

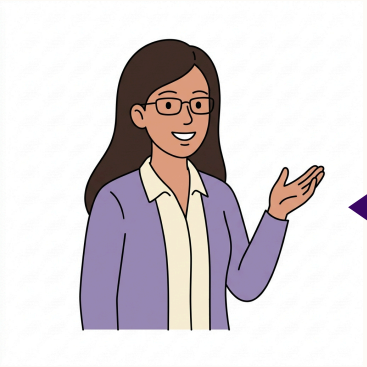
3 **[Make list parallel using imperative verbs]:** • *Wearing eye protection.* • *Wash hands after handling reagents.* • *The disposal of chemical containers.*

4 **[Make list parallel using noun phrases]:** • *Prompt delivery of orders.* • *Invoicing clients accurately.* • *Excellent customer support.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 21.

UNIT 22 • VOCABULARY & PROFESSIONAL REGISTER

22 Register Transformation — Informal Slang to Professional Formal



Abdul

A The Concept in Practice: Corporate Dispute Escalation & Breach of Contract Notice

B Register Calibration: Colloquial vs Formal Standard English

Professional register transforms everyday conversational idioms into precise, objective, Latinate English:

Informal / Colloquial: [get rid of / look into / totally messed up] →

Formal Professional: [eradicate / investigate / severely compromised]

Register Transformation Lexicon:

- **Colloquial → Formal Verb Pairs:** *find out → ascertain*; *set up → establish*; *put off → postpone*; *deal with → manage / address*; *get in touch → contact / liaise.*
- **Tone & Objectivity:** Replace emotional exaggeration (*'terrible disaster', 'ridiculous mistake'*) with measured, factual assessments (*'unacceptable deficiency', 'procedural non-compliance'*).
- **Eliminate Conversational Fillers:** Remove phrases like *'Well', 'You know', 'To be honest', 'Basically', 'At the end of the day'.*

× Common Error

We got in touch with the supplier because they totally messed up our order and we want our money back ASAP.

✓ Model Solution

We contacted the supplier regarding substantial discrepancies in the delivered order and formally requested an immediate refund.

Rule: Replaced informal phrasal verbs and slang ('got in touch', 'totally messed up', 'ASAP') with precise, authoritative commercial terminology ('contacted', 'substantial discrepancies', 'immediate refund').

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 22 Workplace Context (Corporate Di...

1 Identify the sentence written in an appropriate formal business register:

- ☐ We need to look into this issue right away before things get worse.
- ☐ We must investigate this matter immediately prior to further operational deterioration.
- ☐ We've got to sort this mess out ASAP.

2 Which word is the most professional replacement for 'find out' in an audit report?

☐ discover ☐ ascertain ☐ catch on to

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Replace colloquial phrase with formal alternative]:** *The manager promised to deal with the customer complaint.*

4 **[Replace phrasal verb with formal Latinate verb]:** *We will set up a new training programme next quarter.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 22.

UNIT 23 • SPELLING, LEXICON & PROOFREADING

23 Easily Confused Words & Homophones (Affect/Effect, Practice/Practise)

Marcus

A The Concept in Practice: Regional Healthcare Clinical Governance Audit

B Mastering High-Stakes Homophones & Spellings

In UK English, word class determines the spelling of several vital pairs:

Affect = Verb (to influence / alter) ↔ **Effect = Noun (outcome / result)**

-ICE = Noun (PractICE / AdvICE / LicenCE) ↔ **-ISE = Verb (PractISE / AdvISE / LicenSE)**

Mnemonic Hooks & Golden Rules:

- **The RAVEN Rule for Affect/Effect:** **R**emember **A**ffect is a **V**erb; **E**ffect is a **N**oun: *'The new shift rota will **affect** (verb) morale; the positive **effect** (noun) was immediate.'*
- **The ICE Rule for Practice/Practise: ICE is a NOUN.** Words ending in *-ice* are nouns: *'general **practice**', 'legal **advice**', 'driving **licence**'.* Words ending in *-ise* are verbs: *'to **practise** medicine', 'to **advise** patients'.*
- **Compliment vs Complement:** A *compliment* is praise (*'I gave her a compliment'*); a *complement* enhances or completes (*'The dressings complement the treatment'*).

× Common Error

The clinical lead will advise the team on best practise, but the adverse side-affects were unexpected.

✓ Model Solution

The clinical lead will advise the team on best practice, but the adverse side-effects were unexpected.

Rule: Used the noun form 'practice' (-ice is a noun) and the noun 'effects' ('side-effects') instead of the verb form 'affects'.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 23 Workplace Context (Regional He...

1 Select the sentence with correct usage of 'affect' and 'effect':

- ☐ Staff shortages will effect our response times, creating a negative affect on care.
- ☐ Staff shortages will affect our response times, creating a negative effect on care.
- ☐ Staff shortages will affect our response times, creating a negative affect on care.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct UK spelling of the noun 'practice'?

- ☐ The clinic updated its infection control practise.
- ☐ The clinic updated its infection control practice.
- ☐ The clinic updated its infection control practize.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

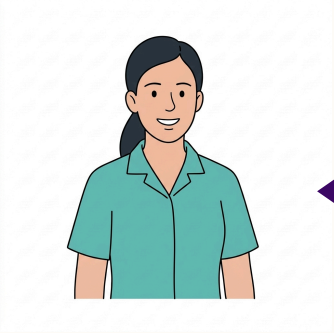
3 **[Insert 'affect' or 'effect']:** *The budget cuts will severely _____ community outreach services.*

4 **[Insert 'practice' or 'practise']:** *Trainee phlebotomists must _____ drawing blood on simulation models.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 23.

UNIT 24 • SPELLING, LEXICON & PROOFREADING

24 Common Confusable Pairs (Accept/Except, Principal/Principle, Loose/Lose)



Sarah

A The Concept in Practice: Corporate Procurement & Financial Audit Briefing

★ B Confusable Pairs: Precision Definitions & Tests

Master these three classic confusable pairs frequently tested in Level 2 functional English examinations:

Accept (Receive / Agree) ↔ **Except (Exclude / Apart from)**

Principal (Head / Main / Capital sum) ↔ **Principle (Moral rule / Fundamental truth)**

Loose (Not tight / Unbound) ↔ **Lose (Misplace / Suffer loss / Fail)**

Examiner Mnemonic Hooks:

- **Principal vs Principle:** Remember: *The Princi**pal** is your **pal*** (or the primary person/amount); a *Princi**ple*** is a *ru**le*** (both end in *-le*).
- **Loose vs Lose:** *Loose* has **two 'o's** — it is too baggy / roomy! *Lose* has lost an 'o'! (*'If your bolts are **loose**, you will **lose** the wheel.'*).
- **Stationary vs Stationery:** *Station**er**y* with an **E** is for **E**nvelopes; *station**ar**y* with an **A** means standing still like a c**ar**.

× Common Error

The finance director agreed in principal, but warned that we might loose our commercial license.

✓ Model Solution

The finance director agreed in principle, but warned that we might lose our commercial licence.

Rule: Corrected 'principal' to 'principle' (rule), 'loose' to 'lose' (suffer loss), and 'license' to the noun 'licence'.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 24 Workplace Context (Corporate Pr...

1 Select the sentence with correct usage of 'principal' and 'principle':

- ☐ The principle reason for the tender rejection was a breach of safety principals.
- ☐ The principal reason for the tender rejection was a breach of safety principles.
- ☐ The principal reason for the tender rejection was a breach of safety principals.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct usage of 'loose' and 'lose'?

- ☐ Do not lose the receipt or you will loose your deposit.
- ☐ Do not loose the receipt or you will lose your deposit.
- ☐ Do not lose the receipt or you will lose your deposit.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

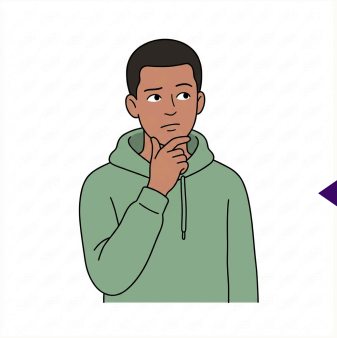
3 **[Insert 'accept' or 'except']:** *All board members approved the annual budget _____ the regional commercial director.*

4 **[Insert 'loose' or 'lose']:** *Worn bearings can cause drive belts to become _____ during high-speed operation.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 24.

UNIT 25 • MORPHOLOGY & WORD FORMATION

25 Word Morphology — Prefixes & Suffixes in Professional English



Sam

A The Concept in Practice: Continuing Professional Development (CPD) Framework

★ B Morphological Architecture: Prefixes, Suffixes & Spelling Rules

Morphology is the study of word formation through base roots, prefixes, and suffixes:

Prefix (Changes Meaning): [un- / dis- / mis- / non- / re- / sub-] + **[Root Word]** + **Suffix (Changes Class): [-tion / -ment / -able / -ise / -ly]**

Three Essential Spelling Rules for Suffixes:

- **1. The Consonant Doubling Rule (1-1-1 Rule):** If a word has one syllable, ends in a single consonant preceded by a single vowel, double the final consonant before adding a vowel suffix: *plan → planned / planning*; *submit → submitted / submitting*.
- **2. Dropping the Silent 'e':** Drop the silent 'e' when adding a vowel suffix: *operate → operation / operating*; *evaluate → evaluation*. Keep the 'e' before consonant suffixes: *management → management*.
- **3. Changing 'y' to 'i':** If a word ends in a consonant + 'y', change 'y' to 'i' before adding suffixes: *rely → reliable / reliance*; *qualify → qualification*.

× Common Error

The apprentice was unresponsible for the misscalculation of the chemical compound.

✓ Model Solution

The apprentice was irresponsible for the miscalculation of the chemical compound.

Rule: Corrected the negative prefix from 'un-' to 'ir-' ('irresponsible') and fixed the spelling of 'miscalculation' (single 's').

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 25 Workplace Context (Continuing P...

1 Identify the correctly formed negative adjective:

☐ unaccurate ☐ inaccurate ☐ disaccurate

2 Which word demonstrates the correct doubling of the consonant before a suffix?

☐ planed ☐ planned ☐ plannd

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

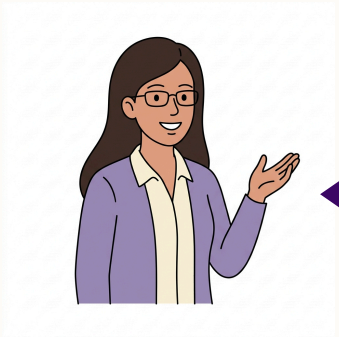
3 **[Add correct negative prefix (un-, in-, dis-, mis-)]:** *The contractor was deemed (competent) _____ after failing the practical test.*

4 **[Form a noun using suffix -ment or -tion]:** *The hospital introduced a new patient (assess) _____ protocol.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 25.

UNIT 26 • VOCABULARY & IDIOMATIC ACCURACY

26 Prepositional Collocations in Business & Healthcare



Priya

A The Concept in Practice: Multi-Agency Healthcare Partnership Service Level Agreement

★ B Collocations: Fixed Prepositions with Verbs & Adjectives

Collocations are words that naturally belong together. In professional English, many verbs, adjectives, and nouns require **fixed prepositions**:

[Compliant / Comply] + WITH • [Adhere / Prior] + TO • [Responsible / Accountable] + FOR

Essential Professional Prepositional Collocations:

- **With 'WITH':** *comply with, coincide with, collaborate with, in accordance with.*
- **With 'TO':** *adhere to, committed to, superior to, refer to, prior to.*
- **With 'FOR':** *eligible for, accountable for, substitute for, responsible for.*
- **With 'OF':** *capable of, consist of, regardless of, in violation of.*
- **With 'IN':** *participate in, specialize in, invest in, confident in.*

× Common Error

All care staff must adhere with the clinical guidelines and comply to CQC standards.

✓ Model Solution

All care staff must adhere to the clinical guidelines and comply with CQC standards.

Rule: Corrected the fixed prepositional pairings: 'adhere' collocates with 'to', and 'comply' collocates with 'with'.

A Tick the correct sentence

Unit 26 Workplace Context (Multi-Agency...

1 Identify the sentence with correct prepositional collocations:

- ☐ The clinic complies with statutory regulations and adheres to national standards.
- ☐ The clinic complies to statutory regulations and adheres with national standards.
- ☐ The clinic complies at statutory regulations and adheres in national standards.

2 Which preposition correctly pairs with 'eligible'?

- ☐ The apprentice is eligible to the higher hourly wage.
- ☐ The apprentice is eligible for the higher hourly wage.
- ☐ The apprentice is eligible with the higher hourly wage.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Correct the preposition error]:** *Staff must adhere with the updated infection control protocols.*

4 **[Insert correct preposition]:** *Candidates who are eligible _____ funding must submit their applications by Friday.*

C Applied Task: Write two sentences using the rules from Unit 26.

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 1: Latin & Greek Prefixes in Professional English

High-utility vocabulary and structural patterns for Functional Skills Level 2 writing.

Anti- (Opposed to / Against)
Antivirus / Anti-discriminatory

Bi- (Two / Twice)
Biannual / Bilateral

Co- / Con- (Together / Jointly)
Collaborative / Concurrent

De- (Reverse / Remove / Down)
De-escalate / Decarbonize

Fore- (Before / In advance)
Forecast / Foresight

Mal- (Bad / Faulty / Wrong)
Malfunction / Malpractice

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 1 • Applied Vocational Exercises

Apply newly acquired vocabulary to authentic vocational contexts.

1. Write a workplace sentence demonstrating precise usage of **Anti-** in a professional report.

2. Explain the exact nuance between **Bi-** and a basic synonym in your own words.

3. Draft an email extract to a colleague incorporating at least two terms from Module 1.

✎ Key Vocabulary Memory Box for Module 1

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 2: High-Impact Suffixes & Word Class Transformations

High-utility vocabulary and structural patterns for Functional Skills Level 2 writing.

Standard (Standardisation)
Standardise

Economy (Economics / Economy)
Economise

Assess (Assessment)
Assess

Comply (Compliance)
Comply

Prior (Priority / Prioritisation)
Prioritise

Signify (Significance)
Signify

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 2 • Applied Vocational Exercises

Apply newly acquired vocabulary to authentic vocational contexts.

1. Write a workplace sentence demonstrating precise usage of **Standard** in a professional report.

2. Explain the exact nuance between **Economy** and a basic synonym in your own words.

3. Draft an email extract to a colleague incorporating at least two terms from Module 2.

✎ Key Vocabulary Memory Box for Module 2

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 3: Workplace Register & Lexical Precision

High-utility vocabulary and structural patterns for Functional Skills Level 2 writing.

Find out (Ascertain / Determine)

We conducted an internal audit to ascertain the exact financial shortfall.

Look into (Investigate / Examine)

Senior management will investigate the health and safety violation.

Carry out (Execute / Implement / Conduct)

The facilities team will conduct unannounced inspections weekly.

Put off (Postpone / Defer)

The disciplinary hearing was postponed until legal counsel arrived.

Get rid of (Eradicate / Eliminate / Dispose of)

The hospital introduced protocols to eliminate clinical contamination.

Bring in (Introduce / Implement)

The logistics hub will introduce biometric access barriers.

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 3 • Applied Vocational Exercises

Apply newly acquired vocabulary to authentic vocational contexts.

1. Write a workplace sentence demonstrating precise usage of **Find out** in a professional report.

2. Explain the exact nuance between **Look into** and a basic synonym in your own words.

3. Draft an email extract to a colleague incorporating at least two terms from Module 3.

✎ Key Vocabulary Memory Box for Module 3

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 4: Essential Business & Administrative Collocations

High-utility vocabulary and structural patterns for Functional Skills Level 2 writing.

Conduct an audit (Stringent regulations)
In compliance with

Reach a consensus (Mitigating circumstances)
Adherence to

Implement measures (Paramount importance)
Eligible for

Exercise discretion (Vested interest)
Discrepancy between

Breach a contract (Binding agreement)
Subject to

Lodge a complaint (Unprecedented demand)
Subsequent to

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 4 • Applied Vocational Exercises

Apply newly acquired vocabulary to authentic vocational contexts.

1. Write a workplace sentence demonstrating precise usage of **Conduct an audit** in a professional report.

2. Explain the exact nuance between **Reach a consensus** and a basic synonym in your own words.

3. Draft an email extract to a colleague incorporating at least two terms from Module 4.

✎ Key Vocabulary Memory Box for Module 4

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 5: Academic & Professional Discourse Markers

High-utility vocabulary and structural patterns for Functional Skills Level 2 writing.

Reinforcing a Point (Furthermore, / Moreover,)

Adds weight to an existing finding or recommendation.

Conceding / Contrasting (Nevertheless, / Conversely,)

Introduces counter-arguments or unexpected limitations.

Demonstrating Cause (Consequently, / Therefore,)

Connects an empirical finding directly to its business impact.

Providing Detail (Specifically, / For instance,)

Presents specific technical data, dates, or regulations.

Stating Priority (Above all, / Fundamentally,)

Highlights the core imperative among several considerations.

Expressing Condition (Provided that, / Unless,)

Establishes non-negotiable contractual or legal prerequisites.

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 5 • Applied Vocational Exercises

Apply newly acquired vocabulary to authentic vocational contexts.

1. Write a workplace sentence demonstrating precise usage of **Reinforcing a Point** in a professional report.

2. Explain the exact nuance between **Conceding / Contrasting** and a basic synonym in your own words.

3. Draft an email extract to a colleague incorporating at least two terms from Module 5.

✎ Key Vocabulary Memory Box for Module 5

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 6: Sector-Specific Technical Vocabulary & Glossary

High-utility vocabulary and structural patterns for Functional Skills Level 2 writing.

Healthcare & Social Care (Safeguarding, Triage, Phlebotomy, Palliative, Holism, Efficacy)

Protocols protecting vulnerable adults, prioritizing clinical urgency, and ensuring holistic patient care.

Construction & Trades (Load-bearing, Remediation, Scaffolding, Subcontractor, Specification, Tolerance)

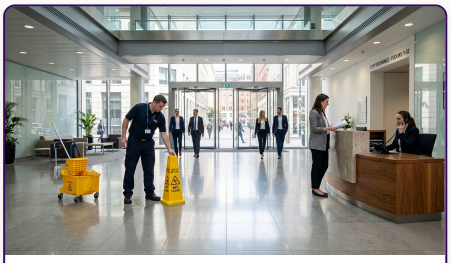
Structural engineering parameters, environmental site clean-up, and compliance with building regulations.

Business & Administration (Procurement, Depreciation, Amortisation, Governance, Stakeholder, Restitution)

Corporate purchasing pipelines, asset balance sheets, board oversight, and legal dispute settlement.

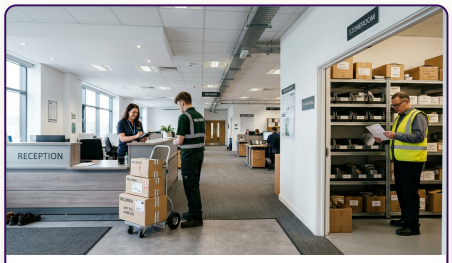
Digital & Information Technology (Latency, Bandwidth, Virtualisation, Encryption, Hypervisor, Redundancy)

Network latency thresholds, cryptographic data security, and hardware backup failover mechanisms.



Logistics & Supply Chain (Consignment, Intermodal, Telematics, Manifest, Demurrage, Inventory)

Freight cargo documentation, vehicle fleet GPS telemetry tracking, and port detention penalty tariffs.



Customer Care & Hospitality (Mediation, Discretionary, Restitution, Escalation, De-escalation, Retention)

Managing customer grievances constructively, offering compensatory goodwill, and reducing client churn.

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 6 • Applied Vocational Exercises

Apply newly acquired vocabulary to authentic vocational contexts.

1. Write a workplace sentence demonstrating precise usage of **Healthcare & Social Care** in a professional report.

2. Explain the exact nuance between **Construction & Trades** and a basic synonym in your own words.

3. Draft an email extract to a colleague incorporating at least two terms from Module 6.

✎ Key Vocabulary Memory Box for Module 6

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 1 TO 5 SYNTHESIS: FRAGMENTS, COMMA SPLICES, FANBOYS, FRONTED ADVERBIALS & PARENTHESIS

1 Workout 1: Additional Workout 1: Sentence Architecture & Boundary Control

▶ INTERNAL MEMO: FACILITY AIR CONDITIONING BREAKDOWN

At 08:30 on Monday the main chiller unit on the roof failed completely. Because the ambient office temperature climbed to 31 degrees Celsius by mid-day. Staff were permitted to work remotely for the remainder of the afternoon, the facilities director contacted emergency heating and ventilation engineers. Furthermore replacement compressor parts, will not arrive until Thursday morning. The maintenance manager who was on site throughout the incident ensured all server room auxiliary chillers remained operational.

	Error Identified in Text	Professional Correction & Rule
1		
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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 6 TO 9 SYNTHESIS: SEMICOLONS, COLONS, DASHES, BRACKETS & HYPHENS

2

Workout 2: Additional Workout 2: Advanced Punctuation Mechanics

TECHNICAL BULLETIN: HIGH-PRESSURE HYDRAULIC VALVE RETROFIT

Before commencing the valve retrofit technicians must: isolate all secondary pressure lines. The maintenance toolkit must include three specialized instruments; a digital torque wrench, a laser alignment caliper, and an ultrasonic flaw detector. The pressure relief valve — which had been inspected only last month (failed catastrophically during initial pressurization. Workshop engineers were operating in a highly-pressurized environment. Fortunately the emergency shut-off system was state of the art.

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 10 TO 12 SYNTHESIS: APOSTROPHES OF OMISSION, SINGULAR/PLURAL POSSESSION & ITS VS IT'S

3

Workout 3: Additional Workout 3: Apostrophes, Contractions & Ownership

PROPERTY MANAGEMENT ADVISORY: COMMERCIAL CAR PARK ALLOCATIONS

All tenant's must ensure that their employees park only in designated company bays. The landlord's representative has noted that several delivery driver's have blocked the emergency access lane. Its imperative that the estate management office maintains it's records accurately. The business centre provides dedicated mens and womens changing suites on the ground floor. If a vehicle does'nt display a valid permit, an automated parking charge notice will be issued immediately.

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 13 TO 16 SYNTHESIS: PAST SIMPLE VS PRESENT PERFECT, PAST CONTINUOUS, MODALS & VOICE

4

Workout 4: Additional Workout 4: Verbs, Tense, Aspect & Diplomatic Voice

INCIDENT INVESTIGATION SUMMARY: DISTRIBUTION WAREHOUSE 3

At 14:10 on Thursday, operative Liam Gallagher was driving a counterbalance forklift along Aisle 7 when he notices a hydraulic fluid spill. He immediately applies the handbrake, but the vehicle skids and collided with a shelving rack. Liam has completed his mandatory forklift refresher certification last month. The accident was investigated by the health and safety committee, and several damaged pallets was removed from the bay. Operatives must to adhere strictly to speed limits at all times.

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 17 TO 21 SYNTHESIS: INDEFINITE PRONOUNS, COLLECTIVE NOUNS, SUBORDINATION, RELATIVE CLAUSES & LISTS

5

Workout 5: Additional Workout 5: Agreement, Subordination & Structural Parallelism

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE: EMERGENCY FIRE EVACUATION

When the fire evacuation alarm sounds, all personnel must follow statutory evacuation protocols: • Cease all workshop machinery operations immediately. • Evacuating through the nearest designated emergency fire exit. • Report directly to the assembly coordinator on Car Park B. • Do not re-enter the facility under any circumstances; Everyone in the administration offices are instructed to leave personal belongings behind. The emergency response team which was established last year has completed the floor sweep. Although the alarm was triggered accidentally but staff responded promptly.

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 22 TO 26 SYNTHESIS: FORMAL REGISTER, TRICKY HOMOPHONES, CONFUSABLE PAIRS, MORPHOLOGY & COLLOCATIONS

6

Workout 6: Additional Workout 6: Lexical Register, Morphology & Confusables

PROCUREMENT POLICY UPDATE: TENDER SUBMISSION COMPLIANCE

The local authority cannot except any commercial bids submitted after the midday deadline. All prospective contractors must adhere with mandatory ethical procurement principals. The overall affect of the revised procurement code will be to ensure total transparency. Suppliers who submit uncomplete documentation will be disqualified from future frameworks. We will look into all submitted tenders thoroughly before awarding the contract.

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 1 TO 5 SYNTHESIS: FRAGMENTS, COMMA SPLICES, FANBOYS, FRONTED ADVERBIALS & PARENTHESIS

7 Workout 7: Additional Workout 1: Sentence Architecture & Boundary Control

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 6 TO 9 SYNTHESIS: SEMICOLONS, COLONS, DASHES, BRACKETS & HYPHENS

8 Workout 8: Additional Workout 2: Advanced Punctuation Mechanics

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 10 TO 12 SYNTHESIS: APOSTROPHES OF OMISSION, SINGULAR/PLURAL POSSESSION & ITS VS IT'S

9

Workout 9: Additional Workout 3: Apostrophes, Contractions & Ownership

PROPERTY MANAGEMENT ADVISORY: COMMERCIAL CAR PARK ALLOCATIONS

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 13 TO 16 SYNTHESIS: PAST SIMPLE VS PRESENT PERFECT, PAST CONTINUOUS, MODALS & VOICE

10

Workout 10: Additional Workout 4: Verbs, Tense, Aspect & Diplomatic Voice

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 17 TO 21 SYNTHESIS: INDEFINITE PRONOUNS, COLLECTIVE NOUNS, SUBORDINATION, RELATIVE CLAUSES & LISTS

11

Workout 11: Additional Workout 5: Agreement, Subordination & Structural Parallelism

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE: EMERGENCY FIRE EVACUATION

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

FORENSIC PROOFREADING • UNITS 22 TO 26 SYNTHESIS: FORMAL REGISTER, TRICKY HOMOPHONES, CONFUSABLE PAIRS, MORPHOLOGY & COLLOCATIONS

12

Workout 12: Additional Workout 6: Lexical Register, Morphology & Confusables

PROCUREMENT POLICY UPDATE: TENDER SUBMISSION COMPLIANCE

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✎ Key Examiner Learning Point & Self-Check Reflection

M1

EXAM PRACTICE • 15 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Exam 1

Mock Writing Exam 1: Exam Mock 1: Formal Incident & Accident Investigation Report

Exam Scenario: Exam Mock 1: Formal Incident & Accident Investigation Report

You are a senior health and safety officer at an automated logistics centre. An operative was injured when an overhead conveyor drive broke. Part 1 requires you to proofread the trainee's incident record (5 deliberate errors). Part 2 requires you to write a 150-word formal investigation report to the operations director.

Writing Task Prompt:
Write a **formal incident investigation report** (approx. 150 words) to the Operations Director. Your report must: (1) state the incident details with consistent past tense, (2) explain the mechanical failure using passive voice where appropriate, (3) propose three remedial safety actions using parallel bullet points preceded by a colon, and (4) maintain a formal, objective register throughout.

Band 4 Writing Checklist

Plan your structure (Opening, 3 Core Paragraphs, Professional Close) before writing.

Examiner Audit Trap

Check every comma splice, homophone, and apostrophe before concluding.

✎ Candidate Initial Planning & Outline Notes

OFFICIAL RULED RESPONSE PAGE

Mock Exam 1 • Candidate Response Booklet

✎ Write your response below:

M2

EXAM PRACTICE • 15 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Exam 2

Mock Writing Exam 2: Exam Mock 2: Business Case & Justification Letter to Senior Management

Exam Scenario: Exam Mock 2: Business Case & Justification Letter to Senior Management

You are an operations coordinator proposing a £45,000 investment in automated barcode scanning systems. Part 1 requires you to proofread the draft proposal summary (5 deliberate errors). Part 2 requires you to write a 150-word persuasive letter to the Chief Financial Officer justifying the capital expenditure.

Writing Task Prompt:
Write a **formal business justification letter** (approx. 150 words) to the Chief Financial Officer (CFO). Your letter must: (1) state the business problem using complex subordination (e.g. 'Although...', 'Whereas...'), (2) justify the investment with specific financial/operational metrics, (3) use diplomatic modal verbs ('could', 'would') to propose implementation timelines, and (4) use correct salutation and sign-off ('Dear Ms Taylor... Yours sincerely').

Band 4 Writing Checklist

Plan your structure (Opening, 3 Core Paragraphs, Professional Close) before writing.

Examiner Audit Trap

Check every comma splice, homophone, and apostrophe before concluding.

✎ Candidate Initial Planning & Outline Notes

OFFICIAL RULED RESPONSE PAGE

Mock Exam 2 • Candidate Response Booklet

✎ Write your response below:

M3

EXAM PRACTICE • 15 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Exam 3

Mock Writing Exam 3: Exam Mock 3: Health & Safety Information Circular & Staff Notice

Exam Scenario: Exam Mock 3: Health & Safety Information Circular & Staff Notice

You are the facilities and compliance manager at a regional college. New chemical handling regulations come into force next month. Part 1 requires you to proofread the draft staff notice (5 deliberate errors). Part 2 requires you to draft a 150-word advisory health and safety circular to all technical and cleaning staff.

Writing Task Prompt:
Write a **comprehensive staff safety circular** (approx. 150 words) regarding safe chemical handling. Your circular must: (1) begin with a fronted adverbial stating statutory context, (2) outline mandatory staff duties using 'must' and 'shall', (3) provide a three-point parallel instruction list preceded by a colon, and (4) ensure accurate distinction between 'practice' (noun) and 'practise' (verb).

Band 4 Writing Checklist

Plan your structure (Opening, 3 Core Paragraphs, Professional Close) before writing.

Examiner Audit Trap

Check every comma splice, homophone, and apostrophe before concluding.

✎ Candidate Initial Planning & Outline Notes

OFFICIAL RULED RESPONSE PAGE

Mock Exam 3 • Candidate Response Booklet

✎ **Write your response below:**

SPAG LEVEL 2 REFERENCE: COMPLETE SOLUTIONS & INDEX

Worked Solutions, Glossary & Index

DIAGNOSTIC SOLUTIONS (QUESTIONS 1–10)

Q1**B**: Unit 1: Resolves fragment by adding subject & finite verb

Q2**B**: Unit 2: Semicolon + conjunctive adverb fixes comma splice

Q3**C**: Unit 3: Comma before FANBOYS when joining two independent clauses

Q4**B**: Unit 4: Comma required after fronted subordinate clause

Q5**C**: Unit 5: Paired commas enclose non-essential clause

Q6**B**: Unit 6: Semicolon links two complete independent clauses

Q7**B**: Unit 7: Colon preceded by complete grammatical sentence

Q8**B**: Unit 8: Brackets enclose acronym definition

Q9**B**: Unit 9: Hyphenate compound adjective before noun; no hyphen for -ly

Q10**B**: Unit 10: Apostrophe replaces omitted 'o' ('doesn't')

DIAGNOSTIC SOLUTIONS (QUESTIONS 11–20)

Q11**A**: Unit 11: Singular 'manager's' and plural 'employees"

Q12**B**: Unit 12: 'It's' = It is; 'its' = possessive pronoun

Q13**B**: Unit 13: Past Simple with specific finished past time

Q14**A**: Unit 14: Past Continuous background + Past Simple interruption

Q15**B**: Unit 15: Diplomatic modal 'Could you please...'

Q16**B**: Unit 16: Objective passive voice avoids personal blame

Q17**B**: Unit 17: 'Everyone' is grammatically singular ('is')

Q18**B**: Unit 18: Rule of proximity matches closest subject ('were')

Q19**B**: Unit 19: Avoids double-conjunction ('Although... but')

Q20**B**: Unit 20: 'who' used for human professional referent

DIAGNOSTIC SOLUTIONS (QUESTIONS 21–30)

Q21**B**: Unit 21: Parallel list begins each bullet with imperative verb

Q22**B**: Unit 22: Formal Latinate vocabulary replaces informal slang

Q23**B**: Unit 23: Affect = verb; Effect = noun (RAVEN rule)

Q24**B**: Unit 23: Practise = verb; Practice = noun (ICE rule)

Q25**B**: Unit 24: Principal = main; Principle = moral rule

Q26**A**: Unit 24: Loose = not tight; Lose = suffer loss

Q27**B**: Unit 25: Negative prefix assimilates before 'r' ('irresponsible')

Q28**B**: Unit 25: Doubling consonant rule in stressed syllable ('referred')

Q29**B**: Unit 26: Fixed collocations: comply WITH / adhere TO

Q30**A**: Unit 26: Fixed collocations: eligible FOR / capable OF

DIAGNOSTIC SOLUTIONS (QUESTIONS 31–40)

Q31**A**: Unit 1: Run-on sentence lacking boundary punctuation

Q32**B**: Unit 2: Comma splice masked by transitional adverb 'however'

Q33**B**: Unit 6: Semicolons separate internally punctuated list items

Q34**B**: Unit 10: Full forms preferred in formal executive reports

Q35**B**: Unit 11: Irregular plural possession takes 's ('women's')

Q36**B**: Unit 16: Active voice pinpoints executive accountability

Q37**B**: Unit 17: 'Each' takes singular auxiliary verb ('has been')

Q38**B**: Unit 22: 'Postpone' formal equivalent of phrasal 'put off'

Q39**A**: Unit 24: Except = excluding; Accept = receive

Q40**B**: Unit 25: Change 'y' to 'i' before suffix '-able' ('reliable')

UNIT 1 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: C, 3: B, 4: C

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...at mid-day, the team finished paving by hand. 2. ...were working overtime... 3. ...was rigorous and identified...

UNIT 2 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: A, 2: B, 3: B, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...arrived late; the doctor... 2. ...rhythms, so the consultant... 3. Because the patient reported severe dizziness, she was...

UNIT 3 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: A, 2: B, 3: A, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...by noon, but... 2. [No comma in compound predicate] 3. ...at dawn and concluded...

UNIT 4 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: B, 3: A, 4: B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...environmental audit, the developer... 2. ...nearby residents, acoustic fencing... 3. ...Section 106 obligations, the contractor...

UNIT 5 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: C, 2: A, 3: A, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...procurement, Mr David Davies, will... 2. ...conduct, published in January, prohibits... 3. ...at 09:00, requested an adjournment.

SPAG LEVEL 2 REFERENCE: COMPLETE SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

UNIT 6 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: C, 3: B, 4: B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...out of service; consequently, residents... 2. ...improved noticeably; sickness absence... 3. ...logs; however, hydration...

UNIT 7 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: A, 3: B, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. Emergency shut-off valves are installed at three locations: Tank A... 2. ...monitor critical parameters: temperature... 3. ...one primary reason: the drive belt...

UNIT 8 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: A, 3: A, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...transformer (rated at 400 kVA) overheated... 2. ...signal box — unmanned for the first time in thirty years — failed... 3. ...unprecedented decision — they suspended...

UNIT 9 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: B, 3: B, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...four-year degree-level apprenticeship... 2. ...exceptionally talented pool... 3. ...re-cover the exposed electrical cables.

UNIT 10 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: A, 3: B, 4: B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...doesn't open... 2. We have reviewed your complaint, but we are not able... 3. ...could have escalated...

UNIT 11 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: A, 2: B, 3: B, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. The auditor's report was... 2. The teachers' rest room was... 3. The men's locker room has been...

UNIT 12 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: A, 3: A, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...its database... 2. It's imperative that... 3. ...operates at its peak...

UNIT 13 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: A, 3: C, 4: B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...signed the formal lease contract on Monday... 2. ...has conducted five unannounced... 3. ...submitted the environmental mitigation plan...

UNIT 14 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: A, 2: B, 3: B, 4: B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. While the electrician was checking the breaker, sparks flew... 2. ...was wearing safety goggles when the grinding disc shattered. 3. ...were repairing the conveyor belt.

UNIT 15 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: C, 2: B, 3: C, 4: C

Section B (Rewrite): 1. Could you please send me the project timeline by the end of the day? 2. ...supervisor should inspect... 3. Lorry drivers must take statutory...

UNIT 16 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: B, 3: B, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. The incorrect consignment was dispatched to the Leeds depot. 2. The subcontractor disposed of three drums... 3. The emergency evacuation plan was updated...

UNIT 17 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: B, 3: A, 4: C

Section B (Rewrite): 1. Everyone in the call centre was trained... 2. Each of the fire alarm sounders is tested... 3. Nobody... has access...

UNIT 18 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: A, 3: A, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. Neither the apprentice nor the technicians were able... 2. Either the team leaders or the shift supervisor is responsible... 3. The investigation committee has concluded...

UNIT 19 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: A, 2: B, 3: B, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. Although the procurement team negotiated a discount, the budget remained... 2. System A processes 500 orders per hour, whereas System B processes... 3. Unless operating expenditure is reduced immediately, the commercial...

UNIT 20 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: A, 3: B, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. The external data auditor who inspected our firewalls... 2. The General Data Protection Regulation, which came into force in 2018, imposes... 3. All servers that store sensitive financial information are securely locked.

SPAG LEVEL 2 REFERENCE: COMPLETE SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

UNIT 21 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: C, 3: C, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. • Wear eye protection. • Wash hands after handling reagents. • Dispose of chemical containers safely. 2. • Prompt delivery of orders. • Accurate invoicing of clients. • Excellent support for customers. 3. All newly hired operatives must meet the following mandatory requirements: • Complete induction. • Submit certificates.

UNIT 22 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: B, 3: B, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. The manager undertook to address the customer complaint. 2. We will establish a new training programme... 3. The delivery driver expressed frustration regarding extended waiting times...

UNIT 23 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: B, 3: B, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...severely affect community... 2. ...must practise drawing blood... 3. ...offered valuable advice regarding...

UNIT 24 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: C, 3: A, 4: A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...annual budget except the regional... 2. ...become loose during... 3. ...loan principal balance.

UNIT 25 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: B, 2: B, 3: B, 4: B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...incompetent after failing... 2. ...patient assessment protocol. 3. ...submitted the project proposal...

UNIT 26 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1: A, 2: B, 3: C, 4: B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. ...adhere to the updated... 2. ...eligible for funding... 3. ...superior to the paper diary.

VOCABULARY IN USE KEYS (MODULES 1–3)

Module 1: irrational, illegitimate, impracticable, counterproductive, bilateral, de-escalate

Module 2: facilitator, sustainable, authority / authorization, feasibility, simplify, adaptability

Module 3: address and resolve, declined, investigating, tolerate, establish, discuss

VOCABULARY IN USE KEYS (MODULES 4–6)

Module 4: reach, lodged, paramount, breach, mitigating, compliance

Module 5: consequently / therefore, nevertheless / conversely, Furthermore / Moreover, Comma after 'Consequently,', Comma after 'however,', Specifically

Module 6: Healthcare & Social Care, Logistics & Supply Chain, Construction & Trades, Financial compensation, Network data delay, Port container detention fee

FORENSIC PROOFREADING WORKOUT 1 KEY

Drill 1: Comma splice, Fragment, Correct, Unnecessary comma, Missing parenthetical comma. Proofreading: Comma after 'Monday,', attach fragment, semicolon '; the facilities', remove comma after 'parts', add opening comma 'manager, who was on site'..

FORENSIC PROOFREADING WORKOUT 2 KEY

Drill 1: We identified three..., Paired dashes, state-of-the-art, rapidly expanding, Staff completed... Proofreading: Remove colon after 'must', replace semicolon with colon, close dash with '— failed', remove hyphen after 'highly', comma after 'Fortunately,'.

FORENSIC PROOFREADING WORKOUT 3 KEY

Drill 1: doesn't, would've, directors', children's, its. Proofreading: Remove apostrophe 'tenants', remove 'drivers', 'It's imperative', 'its records', 'men's and women's', 'doesn't'.

FORENSIC PROOFREADING WORKOUT 4 KEY

Drill 1: completed, sparks flew, Could you please, Twelve files were reviewed, must submit. Proofreading: 'noticed', 'applied', 'completed his... last month', 'pallets were removed', 'must adhere'.

FORENSIC PROOFREADING WORKOUT 5 KEY

Drill 1: has signed, were informed, who, commas required, Although it rained, we worked. Proofreading: Imperative 'Evacuate', bullet full stop '.', 'Everyone... is', commas around 'team, which was established..., has', remove 'but'.

FORENSIC PROOFREADING WORKOUT 6 KEY

Drill 1: affect, practice, principal, lose, comply with. Proofreading: 'accept', 'adhere to', 'principles', 'effect', 'incomplete', 'examine / investigate'.

SPAG LEVEL 2 REFERENCE: COMPLETE SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

WORKPLACE WRITING MOCK 1 MARK SCHEME

1. Missing comma after 'Tuesday,'. 2. Comma splice: '; he suffered'. 3. Past Simple with past time marker: 'inspected the drive belt last Friday'. 4. Subject-verb agreement: 'stop buttons were not'. 5. Contraction apostrophe: 'It's vital'.

WORKPLACE WRITING MOCK 2 MARK SCHEME

1. Double-conjunction: remove 'but' after 'Although'. 2. Confusable pair: 'cannot accept'. 3. Missing comma after conditional: 'scanners, order processing'. 4. Agreement with 'Each': 'centres has reported'. 5. Confusable pair: 'will not lose'.

WORKPLACE WRITING MOCK 3 MARK SCHEME

1. Collocation: 'adhere to statutory'. 2. Collective noun agreement: 'committee has approved'. 3. Comma in compound predicate: remove comma before 'or leave'. 4. Relative pronoun case and noun form: 'who inspected' and 'best practice'. 5. Contraction: 'It's mandatory'.

WORKPLACE WRITING MOCK 4 MARK SCHEME

1. Informal register: 'formally express our dissatisfaction'. 2. Comma splice: '; this has caused'. 3. Irregular verb: 'nothing was done'. 4. Phonetic modal: 'would have switched'. 5. Possessive apostrophe: 'managing director's office'.

WORKPLACE WRITING MOCK 5 MARK SCHEME

1. Subject-verb agreement: 'Everyone who joins the company receives'. 2. Non-defining commas: remove bad comma before 'who'. 3. Possessive noun: 'supervisor's advice' and remove comma in compound predicate. 4. Validated paired dashes. 5. Homophone: 'The overall effect'.

WORKPLACE WRITING MOCK 6 MARK SCHEME

1. Collocation: 'comply with the following'. 2. Parallel structure: 'Don sterile protective gowns'. 3. Terminal punctuation: change semicolon to full stop '.'. 4. Parenthetical commas: 'environment, which operates at ISO Class 5 standards, must'. 5. Modal syntax: 'must halt production'.

ESSENTIAL SPAG GLOSSARY (A–F)

Active Voice
Sentence structure where the subject performs the action (e.g. 'The manager approved the report').

Passive Voice
Sentence structure where the subject receives the action (e.g. 'The report was approved by the manager').

Clause (Main / Independent)
A group of words with a subject and finite verb that can stand alone as a complete sentence.

Clause (Subordinate / Dependent)
A clause that provides extra context but cannot stand alone without an independent clause.

Comma Splice
The error of joining two independent clauses with only a comma instead of a conjunction or semicolon.

Fragment
An incomplete sentence lacking either a main verb or a subject.

ESSENTIAL SPAG GLOSSARY (M–S)

Modal Verb
An auxiliary verb indicating necessity, ability, or probability (e.g. must, should, would, could).

Relative Pronoun
A pronoun (who, which, that, whom, whose) introducing a relative clause.

Semicolon
Punctuation mark (;) used to link closely related independent clauses or separate items in a complex list.

Subject-Verb Agreement
The grammatical rule requiring singular subjects to take singular verbs and plural subjects to take plural verbs.

SPAG LEVEL 2 REFERENCE: COMPLETE SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

SUBJECT, GRAMMAR & MECHANICS INDEX

A

Active and passive voice p.37
Apostrophes for possession p.27
Apostrophes for omission p.25

C

Colons in lists & explanations p.19
Comma splices p.9
Complex sentences p.43

D

Dashes and brackets p.21
Dependent clauses p.43

F

FANBOYS conjunctions p.11
Fragments p.7

H

Homophones & confusables p.51, 53
Hyphens p.23

M

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Candidate SPaG Revision Log

FINAL INDEPENDENT EVALUATION

AUDIT

Candidate SPaG Self-Assessment Matrix & Skill Audit

Pearson Edexcel Level 2 SPaG Benchmark Rubric

Grade your SPaG accuracy against formal Pearson Edexcel Level 2 standards (Band 3 SPaG = 13–15 / 15 marks):

- **Punctuation Variety:** Full stops, commas in complex sentences, semicolons, colons, and apostrophes fully secure.
- **Grammar & Syntax:** Zero comma splices or fragments; accurate subject-verb agreement across collective nouns.
- **Spelling:** Confident command of complex workplace vocabulary and confusable homophone pairs.

✎ Personal Skill Progression & Weakness Remediation Commitments

SIGN

MASTERY SIGN-OFF • PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Candidate SPaG Commitment & Tutor Endorsement

Professional Literacy Declaration

Confirm your ongoing commitment to professional standards of spelling, punctuation, and grammar:

- **Daily Accuracy:** Apply the Golden Rules across all workplace emails, incident logs, and technical reports.
- **Active Demarcation:** Maintain zero tolerance for comma splices, sentence fragments, and apostrophe slips.
- **Lifelong Lexicon:** Continuously expand vocational vocabulary and cross-reference authoritative dictionaries.

Career Impact

Keep this mastery guide at your workstation as a permanent syntax and punctuation quick-reference.

Best Practice

Consistent accuracy in workplace correspondence builds professional credibility and authority.

✎ Tutor Endorsement & Candidate Next Steps

Secure all 16 SPaG marks in your Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Writing exam

- **2-Page Murphy 'Grammar in Use' Layout:** Clear visual rules on the left; progressive practice drills on the right.
- **Anti-Glare Cream Canvas:** #FDFBF7 soft background and 13–14pt Lexend font designed specifically for adult and dyslexia learners.
- **Forensic Proofreading:** Authentic workplace emails, letters, and reports with exact error counts to spot and fix.
- **Full Explanatory Solutions:** Step-by-step model rewrites with examiner commentary for every exercise.

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